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War of the Ring Card Almanac

"One does not simply play every War of the Ring card correctly."

v98 **2025-08**

Base Game Card FAQ, 2nd Edition

by Roy and Ivar

Overview

This document contains FAQs for Event and Combat cards. This is a reference for FAQ notes on Event/Combat cards and not meant to be read in full. Includes all BoardGameGeek Forum notes, all official FAQ sources, and many other answers. Use each entry to clarify any/all play issues that might arise for that specific card. The latest update for this document will always be at this link: https://tinyurl.com/WOTRAlmanac

Cards are marked [C] (Character deck) or [M / A] (Muster/Army in Strategy deck), Free People in **blue**, and Shadow in **red**, and includes their card deck number. Rulebook references: [p41]. Web link references: [web].

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Contents

Overview 1
Contents 1
Understanding Event cards 3
Understanding Combat cards 3
The Hunt for the Ring, Hunt Resolution, Hunt Tile Draws 3
Free Peoples Companions 4
Gandalf the Grey, The Grey Wanderer 4
Gandalf the White, Emissary of the West 4
Strider, Ranger of the North 5
Aragorn, Heir to Isildur 5
Boromir / Gimli / Legolas 5
Meriadoc Brandybuck / Peregrin Took 5
Gollum, Slave of the Ring 6
The Ring-bearers, Frodo & Samwise 6
Shadow Minions 8
The Witch-king, The Black Captain 8
Saruman, Corrupted Wizard 8
The Mouth of Sauron, Lieutenant of Barad-dûr 9
Free Peoples Character Event cards 11
Fellowship Special Hunt Tiles 11
"Elven Cloaks" [C 1] 11
"Elven Rope" [C 2] 11
"Phial of Galadriel" [C 3] 11
"Sméagol Helps Nice Master" [C 4] 11
"Mithril Coat and Sting" [C 5] 11
Fellowship Hunt protection cards 11
"Axe and Bow" [C 6] 11
"Horn of Gondor" [C 7] 11
"Wizard's Staff" [C 8] 12
"Athelas" [C 9] 12
"There is Another Way" [C 10] 12
"I Will Go Alone" [C 11] 12
"Bilbo's Song" [C 12] 12
"Mirror of Galadriel" [C 13] 13
"Challenge of the King" [C 14] 13
"Gwaihir the Windlord" [C 15] 13
"We Prove the Swifter" [C 16] 14
"There and Back Again" [C 17] 14
"The Eagles are Coming!" [C 18] 15
"The Ents Awake" Event cards 15
"The Ents Awake: Treebeard" [C 19] 15
"The Ents Awake: Huorns" [C 20] 15
"The Ents Awake: Entmoot" [C 21] 15
"Dead Men of Dunharrow" [C 22] 15
"House of the Stewards" [C 23] 16
"The Grey Company" [C 24] 16
Free Peoples Strategy Event cards 17
"The Last Battle" [A 1] 17
"A Power Too Great" [A 2] 17
"The Power of Tom Bombadil" [A 3] 17
"Book of Mazarbul" [M 4] 18
"The Spirit of Mordor" [A 5] 18
"Faramir's Rangers" [A 6] 18
"Fear! Fire! Foes!" [M 7] 18

"Wisdom of Elrond" M 8 ... 19
"The Red Arrow" M 9 ... 19
"Help Unlooked For" A 10 ... 19
"Paths of the Woses" A 11 ... 20
Strategy Event cards that recruit Army units ... 21
"The Red Arrow" M 9 ... 21
"Círdan's Ships" M 13 ... 21
"Guards of the Citadel" M 14 ... 21
"Celeborn's Galadhrim" M 15 ... 21
"Riders of Théoden" M 16 ... 21
"Grimbeorn the Old, Son of Beorn" M 17 ... 21
"Imrahil of Dol Amroth" M 18 ... 21
"King Brand's Men" M 19 ... 21
"Swords in Eriador" M 20 ... 21
"Kindred of Glorfindel" M 21 ... 21
"Dain Ironfoot's Guard" M 22 ... 21
"Éomer, Son of Éomund" M 23 ... 21
"Thranduil's Archers" M 24 ... 21
Points for specific Free Peoples recruitment cards ... 21
Points common to all Free Peoples recruitment cards ... 21
Shadow Character Event cards ... 22
Shadow Special Hunt Tiles ... 22
"Shelob's Lair" C 1 ... 22
"The Ring is Mine!" C 2 ... 23
"On, On They Went" C 3 ... 22
"Give it to Uss!" C 4 ... 22
"Orc Patrol" C 5 ... 22
"Isildur's Bane" C 6 ... 23
"Foul Thing from the Deep" C 7 ... 23
"Candles of Corpses" C 8 ... 24
"Nazgûl Search" C 9 ... 24
"Cruel Weather" C 10 ... 24
"The Nazgûl Strike" C 11 ... 24
"Morgul Wound" C 12 ... 25
"Lure of the Ring" C 13 ... 25
"The Breaking of the Fellowship" C 14 ... 25
"Worn with Sorrow and Toil" C 15 ... 26
"Flocks of Crebain" C 16 ... 26
"Balrog of Moria" C 17 ... 27
"The Lidless Eye" C 18 ... 28
"Dreadful Spells" C 19 ... 28
"Grond, Hammer of the Underworld" C 20 ... 28
"The Palantír of Orthanc" C 21 ... 29
"Wormtongue" C 22 ... 29
"The Ringwraiths are Abroad" C 23 ... 30
"The Black Captain Commands" C 24 ... 30
Shadow Strategy Event cards ... 31
"Return to Valinor" A 1 ... 31
"The Fighting Uruk-hai" A 2 ... 31
"Denethor's Folly" A 3 ... 31
"The Day Without Dawn" A 4 ... 31
"Threats and Promises" M 5 ... 32
"Stormcrow" M 6 ... 32
"Shadows Gather" A 7 ... 32
"The Shadow Lengthens" A 8 ... 33
"The Shadow is Moving" A 9 ... 33
"Corsairs of Umbar" A 10 ... 34
Strategy Event cards that recruit Army units ... 34
"Rage of the Dunlendings" M 11 ... 34
"Return of the Witch-king" M 12 ... 34
"Half-orcs and Goblin-men" A 13 ... 34
"Olog-hai" A 14 ... 34
"Hill-trolls" A 15 ... 34
"A New Power is Rising" M 16 ... 34
"Many Kings to the Service of Mordor" M 17 ... 34
"The King is Revealed" M 18 ... 34
"Shadows on the Misty Mountains" M 19 ... 34
"Orcs Multiplying Again" M 20 ... 34
"Horde from the East" M 21 ... 34
"Monsters Roused" M 22 ... 34
"Musterings of Long-planned War" M 23 ... 34
"Pits of Mordor" M 24 ... 34
Points for specific Shadow recruitment cards ... 34
Points common to all Shadow recruitment cards ... 35
Combat cards ordered by initiative ... 36
Battle resolution steps ... 36
Free Peoples Combat cards ... 37
4x "Advantageous Position" (3) ... 37
1x "Andúril" (4) ... 37
1x "Blade of Westernesse" (6) ... 37
3x "Brave Stand" (3) ... 37
2x "Charge" (2) ... 38
2x "Confusion" (4) ... 38
3x "Daring Defiance" (0) ... 38
3x "Daylight" (3) ... 39
1x "Ents' Rage" (3) ... 39
1x "Fateful Strike" (6) ... 39
3x "Heroic Death" (6) ... 39
1x "Huorn-dark" (3) ... 40
4x "It is a Gift" (3) ... 40
2x "Mighty Attack" (4) ... 40
1x "Nameless Wood" (5) ... 40
2x "No Quarter" (5) ... 40
3x "Scouts" (1) ... 40
1x "Servant of the Secret Fire" (3) ... 41
4x "Shield-wall" (6) ... 41

3x "Sudden Strike" (2) 41
3x "Valour" (3) 41
Shadow Combat cards 42
2x "Black Breath" (6) 42
4x "Cruel as Death" (4) 42
3x "Deadly Strife" (3) 42
3x "Desperate Battle" (3) 42
3x "Devilry of Orthanc" (3) 42
3x "Dread and Despair" (3) 42
1x "Durin's Bane" (2) 43
3x "Foul Stench" (3) 43
3x "Great Host" (7) 43
2x "Mûmakil" (3-5) 44
4x "One for the Dark Lord" (3) 44
3x "Onslaught" (7) 44
3x "Relentless Assault" (3) 44
2x "Swarm of Bats" (0) 45
3x "They are Terrible" (4) 45
3x "We Come to Kill" (7) 45
3x "Words of Power" (1) 45
Appendix: Card-play examples 46
Appendix: Moving and Retreating 46
Tolkien Accented Word Lookup Table *Non-accented searches will fail to find a match in the above document. This table shows the correct term to search for.* 47

Understanding Event cards

Event cards can override normal rules, e.g., mustering units into a Stronghold under siege is *not* permitted in the rules, but if Event cards instruct to recruit, the rulebook is overridden. A card cannot muster into an *enemy-controlled* region unless it explicitly states so. However, if an Event card specifies recruiting in certain regions, the usual mustering rules are superseded (e.g., "Dead Men of Dunharrow").

• **Event cards play conditions in bold** are *required* to play a card (including for "Play on the table" cards).

• **"Play on the table" cards** are played onto the table using an Action die if their play condition is met. Once in play on the table, they do not count towards hand size. They are removed from play if any discard condition noted on the card is met *or* if the *play condition* is no longer valid at the *end* of an Action. web

• **Main text on Event cards** are instructions to perform and must be executed to the maximum possible extent, i.e., *all* instructions should be followed, except for optional points (often written as "you *may*…"). p22

• **Settlements** (Towns, Cities and Strongholds) are often mentioned. These are *muster* regions and contain a diamond icon. **Fortifications** (Osgiliath and Fords of Isen) are *not* Settlements (so cannot normally muster there).

• **The hand limit is six cards**. Draw *all* cards required for a given card draw, *then* discard down to six cards. web

Understanding Combat cards

• The attacker selects a Combat card (or not) face down after which the defender selects a Combat card (or not). Then reveal cards simultaneously. Mistakes can happen (e.g. playing "Cruel as Death" when Gandalf the White is using his "White Rider" ability, which negates Nazgûl Leadership making "Cruel as Death" an illegal card play), so a polite convention is to allow a player to take back an illegal card play (i.e., if it is not possible to play the card).

• The "initiative" listed on a Combat card is used to decide where in the Combat round a given card will have effect. If initiatives are tied, the *defender's* card is always fully resolved first.

The Hunt for the Ring, Hunt Resolution, Hunt Tile Draws

Many Event cards relate to the Hunt, and it is important to follow the steps for Hunt tile draws in order. p40

1. After a tile is drawn (note that it could be blocked by "Wizard's Staff" or redrawn by "Mithril Coat and Sting"), only *one* "Play on the table" Hunt protection card may be applied, i.e., "Axe and Bow" or "Horn of Gondor".

2. The Guide's special abilities may be used (note Meriadoc, Peregrin, and Gollum abilities here), then optionally take a "casualty" to sustain damage (either the Guide *or* a random Companion can absorb damage equal to that Companion's level); if this results in a new Guide, then *repeat* this step with the new Guide's abilities, e.g., if Peregrin becomes the new Guide, his Guide ability is *immediately* available *during* this current step.

3. Any remaining damage *must* be dealt with by taking direct Corruption ("using the Ring").

4. Reveal the Fellowship if required. If Gollum is the Guide, he may ignore a "reveal" icon but only on *standard* numbered tiles ("Eye" tiles or red Shadow Special tiles with "reveal" icons will *always* reveal the Fellowship).

Free Peoples Companions

Companion	Activate Nation	Activate & Advance with any die	Level	Movement	Leadership	+1 Combat Strength	Separate to reduce Hunt damage by 1
Gandalf the Grey, The Grey Wanderer	**Any**	**No**	3	3	1	**Yes**	**No**
Gandalf the White, Emissary of the West	**Any**	**No**	3	3/4 [a]	1/0 [b]	**No**	**n.a.**
Strider, Ranger of the North	**North**	**No**	3	3	1	**Yes**	**No**
Aragorn, Heir to Isildur	**Any**	**No**	3	3	2	**Yes**	**n.a.**
Boromir, Son of Denethor	**Gondor**	**Gondor**	2	2	1	**Yes**	**No**
Gimli, Son of Gloin	**Dwarven**	**Dwarven**	2	2	1	**Yes**	**No**
Legolas, Son of Thranduil	**Elven**	**Elven**	2	2	1	**Yes**	**No**
Meriadoc, Hobbit Companion	**Any**	**No**	1	1	1	**No**	**Yes**
Peregrin, Hobbit Companion	**Any**	**No**	1	1	1	**No**	**Yes**

a. Gandalf the White can move up to 4 regions **alone** (or with a **single** Hobbit), but 3 regions when moving with any other Companions.
b. Gandalf the White has 1 Leadership, or 0 Leadership if he uses The White Rider to forfeit Leadership for the entire battle.

Gandalf the Grey, The Grey Wanderer

Level 3. Leadership 1. Can activate any Nation (at a City or Stronghold). ***Captain of the West.***



• **Guide ability.** This allows drawing the same type of card just played, but only if an Event result is used and Gandalf is the Guide at the *end* of the Action. Example 1. Gandalf is the Guide. An Event Action die result is used to play "I Will Go Alone" and Gandalf separates from the Fellowship. At the end of the Action, Gandalf is no longer Guide, so his Guide ability is not triggered. [web] Example 2. Strider is the Guide and Gandalf is also in the Fellowship. An Event result is used to play "I Will Go Alone" and Strider separates, so Gandalf becomes the Guide (as he is now the highest-Level Companion in the Fellowship) and so the Free Peoples player *may* trigger this ability.

• If the Guide ability is used after using an *Event* die to play a card that provides an additional card draw, the Free Peoples Player may draw ***twice*** (once for the card, and then *again* for Gandalf's Guide ability). [web]

• **Captain of the West.** Adds 1 to the Combat Strength of a Free Peoples Army with this Companion (cumulative if more **Captains of the West** are in the battle) up to a maximum of 5 Combat dice.

Gandalf the White, Emissary of the West

Level 3. Leadership 1. Can activate any Nation (at a City or Stronghold).



• Use a Will of the West Action die result to bring Gandalf the White into play if **a)** Gandalf the Grey has been eliminated or has left the Fellowship, *and* **b)** any valid Minion is (or has been) in play (e.g., if Saruman entered play and then was eliminated, and no other Minion is on the board, Gandalf *may* come into play). If Gandalf the Grey is outside of the Fellowship and in play, replace him with Gandalf the White; otherwise, place Gandalf the White in Fangorn or in an *unconquered* Elven Stronghold (including a Stronghold that is currently under siege).

• If Gandalf the White is currently in play at any Recover Action dice phase, gain his additional Action die for his presence in the game. If Gandalf the White is eliminated in a turn, do not remove his additional die from play; it will remain in play until the next Recover Action dice phase.

• Note that although Gandalf the Grey, The Grey Wanderer has the **Captain of the West** ability, Gandalf the White does *not*. Gandalf the White instead has the **White Rider** combat ability.

• **White Rider.** This can *only* be announced at the very start of a battle and lasts for the entirety of that battle (i.e., it cannot be turned on or off at each new Combat round; it is either on for the whole battle or off for the whole battle and is decided before Combat card declaration). Gandalf *forfeits* his Leadership to use this ability which is why "Daring Defiance" is playable (as a least one Companion is in the battle) but has *no effect* since all Companions in the battle *cannot* forfeit their Leadership as required by "Daring Defiance". The Shadow player *cannot* play any card that requires *Nazgûl* Leadership when this ability is in

use (e.g., "Dread and Despair", "Foul Stench", "They are Terrible"), but *may* play cards that require the *presence* of Nazgûl (e.g., "Black Breath", "Words of Power").

• **Shadowfax.** Gandalf the White is level 4 *for movement*, but *only* if he is alone *or* with a single Hobbit, and he is level 3 when moving with other Companions and in battle.

Strider, Ranger of the North *Level 3. Leadership 1. Can activate* ***only*** *The North (at The Shire or Dale).* ***Captain of the West.***



• Strider (either version) can activate the North by ending movement in The Shire or Dale but *cannot* advance them on the Political Track. He cannot activate Gondor (or any other Nations) until after he is crowned as King using the **Heir to Isildur** ability.

• **Captain of the West.** Adds 1 to the Combat Strength of a Free Peoples Army with this Companion (cumulative if more **Captains of the West** are in the battle) up to a maximum of 5 Combat dice.

• **Heir to Isildur.** This ability cannot be used in a required region if it is conquered (the only valid regions are Minas Tirith, Dol Amroth, or Pelargir), e.g., even if Strider is in a Free Peoples Army that has besieged a *conquered* Minas Tirith, he may *not* use this ability there unless Minas Tirith is recaptured. There is no restriction on using this ability with a Free Peoples Army that is currently besieged inside a Stronghold.

Aragorn, Heir to Isildur *Level 3. Leadership* ***2****. Can activate* ***any*** *Nation (at a City or Stronghold).* ***Captain of the West.***



• If Aragorn is in play at the Recover Action dice phase, gain his additional Action die for his presence in the game. If Aragorn is eliminated in a turn, do *not* remove his additional die from play; it will remain in play until the next Recover Action dice phase.

• **Captain of the West.** Adds 1 to the Combat Strength of a Free Peoples Army with this Companion (cumulative if more **Captains of the West** are in the battle) up to a maximum of 5 Combat dice.

• Aragorn will activate any Nation if he ends movement or enters play at a City or Stronghold of that Nation. If Gondor is not activated, it will be activated when Aragorn is brought into play.

Boromir, Son of Denethor *Level 2. Leadership 1. Can activate Gondor (at a City or Stronghold).* ***Captain of the West.***
Gimli, Son of Gloin *Level 2. Leadership 1. Can activate Dwarves (at Erebor).* ***Captain of the West.***
Legolas, Son of Thranduil *Level 2. Leadership 1.* ***Captain of the West.***







• **Guide ability.** These Companions have *no* Guide ability. Hence, if they become Guide during a Hunt (because of another Companion being taken as a casualty), any additional Hunt damage will be applied as direct Corruption.

• Activate their home Nation if they are separated and end movement at a City or Stronghold of that Nation (does not apply if they are still in the Fellowship, but the Fellowship figure can activate any Nation if it stops at a City or Stronghold of that Nation regardless of which Companions are in the Fellowship).

• Each Companion has an ability to advance their respective Nation on the Political track when in a City or Stronghold of that Nation, spending any Action die result.

• **Captain of the West.** Adds 1 to the Combat Strength of a Free Peoples Army with this Companion (cumulative if more **Captains of the West** are in the battle) up to a maximum of 5 Combat dice.

Meriadoc Brandybuck, Hobbit Companion *Level 1. Leadership 1. Can activate any Nation (at a City or Stronghold).*
Peregrin Took, Hobbit Companion *Level 1. Leadership 1. Can activate any Nation (at a City or Stronghold).*





• **Guide ability.** *"During the Hunt, if the Hunt damage is one or more, separate Meriadoc from the Fellowship to reduce the Hunt damage by one".* The Hunt damage must be one or more, so this ability cannot be used in any non-Hunt situation. If multiple Companions separate to reduce damage in this way (i.e. if both Hobbits separate) for a *single* Hunt tile, then they separate as a group and must end movement in the same region Resolve each tile fully before drawing another if there are multiple Hunt tiles in the same Action. *See*

Separating to reduce Hunt damage and multiple Hunt tile draws *in* ***The Ring-bearers*** *entry for when these Companions use their* ***Guide*** *or* ***Take Them Alive!*** *ability.*

• **Take Them Alive!** This ability applies during both Hunt and non-Hunt events, when their Guide ability cannot apply. For example, if one of the Hobbits is drawn by "Lure of the Ring" (a non-Hunt Event), he may use this ability to avoid elimination and can move up to 1 region (as their movement level is 1). This ability cannot be used on the Mordor Track as stated on the card.

• Activate *any* Nation by ending movement at a City or Stronghold of that Nation.

• These Hobbits are *not* **Captains of the West** but do have a Leadership of 1.

Gollum, Slave of the Ring



• **Guide ability. (i)** Gollum *ignores* reveal icons, but *only* on standard (beige) *numbered* Hunt tiles, i.e., standard "Eye" tiles, and red Shadow Special Hunt tiles that show a reveal icon will *always* reveal the Fellowship if Gollum is the Guide (unless the outcome is altered by, e.g., "Mithril Coat and Sting". **(ii)** Gollum may reveal the Fellowship during a Hunt to reduce Hunt damage by 1, on *any* tile (*even* red Shadow Special Hunt tiles), *unless* the Fellowship is already revealed or was revealed by the tile already (an "Eye" tile or red Shadow Special Hunt tile with a reveal icon will *always* reveal the Fellowship).

• Any Guide abilities may be used *immediately* when a new Guide is chosen, *including* mid-Hunt resolution. e.g., a "2 with reveal icon" Hunt tile is drawn and only Meriadoc is left in the Fellowship. He uses his Guide ability to separate and reduce damage by 1, then as Gollum is now the Guide, he ignores the reveal icon. The remaining 1 damage can either be resolved by taking 1 point of Corruption, *or*, by using Gollum's Guide ability to reveal the Fellowship to reduce damage by 1.

• If the Fellowship declares into an unconquered Free Peoples City or Stronghold and the "Balrog of Moria" card causes Hunt Damage, Gollum's ability to reveal and reduce damage *cannot* be used to reveal in that City or Stronghold. E.g., The Fellowship declares from Rivendell into an unconquered Lórien with only a Hobbit (Level 1) Companion left in the Fellowship, passing through Moria and the "Balrog of Moria" card is in play on the table. In order, **a)** Heal 1 Corruption due to declaring into Lórien, then **b)** Draw a Hunt tile for the "Balrog of Moria" card. A "3" tile is drawn, and the last Companion in the Fellowship is eliminated, and Gollum becomes the Guide, leaving 2 Corruption to deal with. Gollum *cannot* use his ability to reveal the Fellowship in Lórien to reduce damage by 1 due to the restriction on revealing into an unconquered Free Peoples City or Stronghold so the 2 Corruption must be taken as direct damage.

The Ring-bearers, Frodo & Samwise *Can activate any Nation (at City or Stronghold).*



• If the Fellowship Track is at 0, then the Ring-bearers figure represents the position of the Fellowship. At 1 or more, the figure represents the "last known position" of the Fellowship; the true location is not known until they reveal or declare (moving the Ring-bearers figure *up to* the number of regions on the Fellowship Track). The Fellowship Track always stays at 0 when the Fellowship is in Mordor.

• **Declaring the Fellowship must follow these steps: a)** If the Fellowship declares into an *unconquered* Free Peoples City or Stronghold (which is permitted even if a Stronghold is under siege), Sméagol *must* leave the Fellowship if he is in play; the Fellowship may heal 1 point of Corruption and activate that Free Peoples Nation, **or** if the region declared into is a *conquered* Free Peoples City or Stronghold, Sméagol may remain as Guide if he is in play; the Fellowship may *not* heal Corruption or activate Politics for that Nation. **b)** If the "Balrog of Moria" card is in play, the Shadow player may activate its effect (see that card's entry for details).

• **Separating to reduce Hunt damage and multiple Hunt tile draws.** Some Companions have abilities that allow them to separate to reduce damage during a Hunt. These separations must **a)** take place from the position of the Ring-bearers figure at the time that the tile was drawn, and **b)** if multiple Companions separate *on the same Hunt tile*, then they must move as a group. **Example.** The Fellowship is in Hollin and only the two Hobbit remain in the Fellowship. The Fellowship moves once and the Hunt fails, then moves

again, and the Hunt is a success and a "3" tile is drawn. The Free Peoples player decides to separate the Hobbit who is Guide to reduce damage by 1, and then, as the remaining Hobbit becomes the Guide, he can separate also to reduce damage by 1, and then, as Gollum becomes the Guide, he can use his Guide ability to reduce damage by 1 by revealing the Fellowship. As both separations were on the same Hunt tile, the two Hobbits must move together; and can move up to 3 regions (Fellowship Track of 2 plus their Level 1 for movement) from the location of the Ring-bearers figure at the point the Hunt tile is drawn (i.e., Hollin). They cannot move through Moria to Lórien due to the restriction that Companions may move into, but not through, an unconquered Shadow Stronghold , so instead move 3 regions to The Shire (and as it is a City, The North Nation will activate, if it is not already). The Ring-bearers figure is moved to Dimrill Dale and revealed, and the Fellowship Track goes to 0. Finally, a Hunt tile for revealing while moving through a Shadow Stronghold is applied.

• **Separating Companions in a besieged or conquered Free Peoples Stronghold.** If the Ring-bearers figure is at a Free Peoples Stronghold that is currently ***unconquered*** but besieged by a Shadow Army, any Companions that separate must join the Free Peoples Army inside that Stronghold and may not leave that region while it is besieged. However, if the Ring-bearers figure is at a Free Peoples Stronghold that is ***conquered***, Companions that separate from the Fellowship may freely move out of that region.

• If a Companion is to be randomly picked from the Fellowship (during a Hunt, or for cards like "Foul Thing from the Deep" or "Lure of the Ring", the Shadow player *always* performs this action.

• The Ring-bearers figure cannot end movement in an unconquered Free Peoples City or Stronghold when they are revealed. [web] However, they *may* move *through* such a region while being. The restriction is simply that the Ring-bearers cannot *end* movement revealed in an unconquered Free Peoples City or Stronghold.

• The Shadow player may only ever place a **maximum** number of dice in the Hunt Pool equal to the number of Companions in the Fellowship (Gollum does not act as a Companion, but the rules state that the Shadow player may always place at least one die in the Hunt Pool).

• In Mordor, if the Fellowship does not **move** or **hide** in a turn, take one Corruption at the end of the turn (this is not Hunt Damage, so this cannot be cancelled by taking a casualty or using a card like "Axe and Bow"). Note that this is *before* the military victory condition check; if Corruption moves to 12 due to this, the Shadow player *immediately* wins the game (even if the Free Peoples is at 4 Victory Points).

• Each of the following in the same region as the Ring-bearers figure provides Shadow ***one*** Hunt re-roll (for up to a maximum of three re-rolls, one for each item in this list):
(i) Any number of Nazgûl (including either version of Witch-king).
(ii) Any number of Shadow Army units.
(iii) An ***unconquered*** Shadow Stronghold, **or** a ***conquered*** Free Peoples Stronghold.

*- Cities (Shadow or Free Peoples, conquered or unconquered) do **not** provide additional Hunt re-rolls.*
*- Shadow Minions (except for the Witch-king) do **not** provide any additional Hunt re-rolls.*

Shadow Minions

The Witch-king, The Black Captain

Gandalf the White may enter play if this Minion is (or has been) in play.



• The Sauron Nation ***and*** at least one Free Peoples Nation must be "At War" to bring The Black Captain into play. Use a Muster Action die result to place the Witch-king with an Army that contains at least one Sauron Army unit (Nazgûl are *not* Sauron Army units, so do not qualify for this). There is no restriction on doing this into a Shadow Army that is currently besieged inside a Stronghold. Activate all Free Peoples Nations when the Black Captain enters play but if the "Wormtongue" card is already in play on the table then Rohan will *not* be activated on the Political Track (note also, if "Wormtongue" is discarded due to Saruman being eliminated, Rohan will *still* not activate if the Witch-king is already in play, as it is only when he enters play that the Nation activations happen).

• The Black Captain has a Leadership of 2 and is a Nazgûl with flying movement, i.e., can move anywhere on the board, *except* to unconquered Free Peoples Strongholds that are not under siege by a Shadow Army), including to enter or leave a region containing a Shadow Army besieged inside a Stronghold.

• **Sorcerer.** Draw the same type of Event card as that used in the first Combat round of a battle in which the Black Captain participated (note that Gandalf the White's "White Rider" cannot prevent this ability, but if the Black Captain is in a *rearguard* or is *eliminated* during the first Combat round, this ability *cannot* trigger [web]). The played card must be "used", and "Combat cards are always discarded as soon as the Combat round is over" [p29], so this is only after all Combat round steps are complete (i.e., all casualties resolved, and, if a siege battle, the attacker must downgrade an Elite to a Regular if he wants to continue the attack to the next round). The Step 5 decision "Choose to Cease the attack or Retreat" must also be complete, i.e., if a retreat happens that must be fully resolved before the Sorcerer card is drawn. Note that this is *before* advance after combat, and so the drawn card may be looked at by the Shadow player to inform his decision on whether to advance or not if Shadow is attacking.

Saruman, Corrupted Wizard

Gandalf the White may enter play if this Minion is (or has been) in play.



• Use a Muster Action die result to place Saruman in Orthanc if **a)** Isengard is "At War", and **b)** Orthanc is unconquered. Saruman may enter play if a Shadow Army is besieged inside Orthanc but may *not* enter play if Orthanc is conquered and a Shadow Army has besieged it. However, if Orthanc was captured, and Orthanc is recaptured, and Saruman has never been in play, then Saruman *may* be brought into play, i.e., he may only be brought into play once per game, but only at a time when Orthanc is unconquered.

• Saruman has a Leadership of 1, and has a movement of 0, i.e., Saruman can never leave Orthanc.

• If Saruman is in play and Orthanc has no Army units and a Free Peoples Army *moves* into that region to capture the Stronghold, Saruman is *not* eliminated (he is protected inside "*the black, impenetrable tower of Isengard built by the Dúnedain*"). If a Shadow Army later besieges Orthanc, Saruman immediately joins that Shadow Army in the region of Orthanc (and may be eliminated in that battle).

• **Battles involving Saruman.**
(i) If a Shadow Army besieges a captured Orthanc while Saruman is in play, Saruman immediately joins the Shadow Army (this can happen if Saruman was alone in Orthanc and a Free Peoples Army captures Orthanc, so that Saruman remains in play, as per the previous point).
(ii) If a Free Peoples Army attacks Orthanc (from an adjacent region, or has already besieged a Shadow Army inside Orthanc, or sorties out from inside a conquered and besieged Orthanc), Saruman is *with* the Shadow Army (and may not be held in a rearguard as that is not possible for a defending Army).
(iii) Saruman may use a Character Action die result to attack an adjacent region (even if he is the only source of Leadership) but may *not* advance after battle to the attacked region (however, Army units and other Leaders with him may do so). [web]
(iv) Saruman is eliminated in any battle in which all Shadow Army units with him are eliminated.

• **Retreats involving Saruman.** If a Free Peoples Army attacks a Shadow Army in Orthanc that is not under siege, and the Shadow Army can retreat, the Shadow Army may **a)** retreat *with* Saruman into siege inside Orthanc (if that is possible), or **b)** retreat to an adjacent free region, *leaving Saruman behind* in Orthanc. Saruman remains in play even if the Free Peoples Army captures Orthanc.

• If Saruman is the *only* leadership in Orthanc, the Shadow Player may *not* use a Character result to *move* an Army out of Orthanc, as at least one Leader must move *with* the Army when moving in this way, which Saruman cannot do.

• If Saruman is in play and no Shadow Army units are in Orthanc, an "Ent's Awake" card will eliminate Saruman (but *not* any other Minions or Nazgûl there in this case).

• **The Voice of Saruman.** Various cards allow recruiting when under siege, but this ability states *"under your control and not under siege"* so cannot be used either when a Shadow Army is besieged inside Orthanc *or* even when a Shadow Army has besieged a Free Peoples Army inside Orthanc (it is possible for Saruman to still be in play in this situation if a Free Peoples Army moves into an empty Orthanc when Saruman is already in play, but he may not use this ability at all in this case). If any of North Dunland, or South Dunland are captured when this ability is used, do not recruit into the captured region(s).

• **Servants of the White Hand.** If Saruman is eliminated, the Isengard Elites lose this leadership *immediately*, e.g., if Orthanc is besieged and attacked, and Saruman is eliminated by "Blade of Westernesse" or "Fateful Strike" (both initiative 6), the Isengard Elites lose their leadership at that point from the moment that Saruman is eliminated (initiative 6 in this case) and for the rest of the battle.

The Mouth of Sauron, Lieutenant of Barad-dûr

Gandalf the White may enter play if this Minion is (or has been) in play.



• The Sauron Nation does *not* need to be "At War" to recruit the Mouth of Sauron, Lieutenant of Barad-dûr. Use a Muster Action die result to place The Mouth of Sauron in any ***unconquered*** Sauron Stronghold (i.e., cannot be Orthanc, Umbar or Angmar, but could be a besieged Sauron Stronghold), if either **(i)** the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track, *or* **(ii)** all Free People Nations are "At War". There is no restriction on doing this into a Sauron Stronghold containing a Shadow Army under siege.

• The Mouth of Sauron has a Leadership of 2 and can move up to 3 regions (non-flying movement, i.e., he cannot enter or leave a region containing a Shadow Army besieged inside a Stronghold). When moving without an Army he cannot be moved into a region containing a Stronghold controlled by the Free Peoples unless it is besieged by a Shadow Army.

• **Messenger of the Dark Tower.** The Shadow Player can use a Muster Action die result "as an Army result", and so can move up to two Armies, or initiate an attack with one Army (that Army does *not* need to contain the Mouth) or play a Strategy Event card that shows an Army symbol. This ability may only be used once per turn.

Free Peoples Character Event Cards

"Elven Cloaks" C 1 *It is a Gift (3)*
"Elven Rope" C 2 *It is a Gift (3)*
"Phial of Galadriel" C 3 *It is a Gift (3)*
"Sméagol Helps Nice Master" C 4 *It is a Gift (3)*
"Mithril Coat and Sting" C 5 *Blade of Westernesse (6)*
"Axe and Bow" C 6 *Mighty Attack (4)*
"Horn of Gondor" C 7 *Mighty Attack (4)*
"Wizard's Staff" C 8 *Servant of the Secret Fire (3)*
"Athelas" C 9 *Andúril (4)*
"There is Another Way" C 10 *Heroic Death (6)*
"I Will Go Alone" C 11 *Daring Defiance (0)*
"Bilbo's Song" C 12 *Fateful Strike (6)*
"Mirror of Galadriel" C 13 *Heroic Death (6)*
"Challenge of the King" C 14 *Sudden Strike (2)*
"Gwaihir the Windlord" C 15 *Daring Defiance (0)*
"We Prove the Swifter" C 16 *Daring Defiance (0)*
"There and Back Again" C 17 *Brave Stand (3)*
"The Eagles are Coming!" C 18 *Heroic Death (6)*
"The Ents Awake: Treebeard" C 19 *Nameless Wood (5)*
"The Ents Awake: Huorns" C 20 *Huorn-dark (3)*
"The Ents Awake: Entmoot" C 21 *Ents' Rage (3)*
"Dead Men of Dunharrow" C 22 *Sudden Strike (2)*
"House of the Stewards" C 23 *Brave Stand (3)*
"The Grey Company" C 24 *Brave Stand (3)*

Free Peoples Strategy Event Cards (Army / Muster)

"The Last Battle" A 1 *Daylight (3)*
"A Power Too Great" A 2 *No Quarter (5)*
"The Power of Tom Bombadil" A 3 *Advantageous Position (3)*
"Book of Mazarbul" M 4 *Advantageous Position (3)*
"The Spirit of Mordor" A 5 *Scouts (1)*
"Faramir's Rangers" A 6 *Shield-wall (6)*
"Fear! Fire! Foes!" M 7 *Shield-wall (6)*
"Wisdom of Elrond" M 8 *Confusion (4)*
"The Red Arrow" M 9 *Scouts (1)*
"Help Unlooked For" A 10 *No Quarter (5)*
"Paths of the Woses" A 11 *Sudden Strike (2)*
"Through a Day and a Night" A 12 *Confusion (4)*
"The Red Arrow" M 9 *Scouts (1)*
"Círdan's Ships" M 13 *Charge (2)*
"Guards of the Citadel" M 14 Charge (2)
"Celeborn's Galadhrim" M 15 *Daylight (3)*
"Riders of Théoden" M 16 *Daylight (3)*
"Grimbeorn the Old, Son of Beorn" M 17 *Scouts (1)*
"Imrahil of Dol Amroth" M 18 *Shield-wall (6)*
"King Brand's Men" M 19 *Shield-wall (6)*
"Swords in Eriador" M 20 *Advantageous Position (3)*
"Kindred of Glorfindel" M 21 *Advantageous Position (3)*
"Dain Ironfoot's Guard" M 22 *Valour (3)*
"Éomer, Son of Éomund" M 23 *Valour (3)*
"Thranduil's Archers" M 24 *Valour (3)*

Shadow Character Event cards

"Shelob's Lair" C 1 *One for the Dark Lord (3)*
"The Ring is Mine!" C 2 *One for the Dark Lord (3)*
"On, On They Went" C 3 *One for the Dark Lord (3)*
"Give it to Uss!" C 4 *One for the Dark Lord (3)*
"Orc Patrol" C 5 *Cruel as Death (3)*
"Isildur's Bane" C 6 *Cruel as Death (3)*
"Foul Thing from the Deep" C 7 *They are Terrible (4)*
"Candles of Corpses" C 8 *Dread and Despair (3)*
"Nazgûl Search" C 9 *Foul Stench (3)*
"Cruel Weather" C 10 *Cruel as Death (3)*
"The Nazgûl Strike" C 11 *Black Breath (6)*
"Morgul Wound" C 12 *Black Breath (6)*
"Lure of the Ring" C 13 *They Are Terrible (4)*
"The Breaking of the Fellowship" C 14 *Dread and Despair (3)*
"Worn with Sorrow and Toil" C 15 *Words of Power (1)*
"Flocks of Crebain" C 16 *They are Terrible (4)*
"Balrog of Moria" C 17 *Durin's Bane (2)*
"The Lidless Eye" C 18 *Words of Power (1)*
"Dreadful Spells" C 19 *Devilry of Orthanc (3)*
"Grond, Hammer of the Underworld" C 20 *Dread and Despair (3)*
"The Palantír of Orthanc" C 21 *Cruel as Death (3)*
"Wormtongue" C 22 *Foul Stench (3)*
"The Ringwraiths are Abroad" C 23 *Words of Power (1)*
"The Black Captain Commands" C 24 *Foul Stench (3)*

Shadow Strategy Event cards (Army/Muster)

"Return to Valinor" A 1 *Deadly Strife (3)*
"The Fighting Uruk-hai" A 2 *Onslaught (7)*
"Denethor's Folly" A 3 *Devilry of Orthanc (3)*
"The Day Without Dawn" A 4 *Relentless Assault (3)*
"Threats and Promises" M 5 *Devilry of Orthanc (3)*
"Stormcrow" M 6 *Great Host (7)*
"Shadows Gather" A 7 *Mûmakil (3-5)*
"The Shadow Lengthens" A 8 *Mûmakil (3-5)*
"The Shadow is Moving" A 9 *Swarm of Bats (0)*
"Corsairs of Umbar" A 10 *Deadly Strife (3)*
"Rage of the Dunlendings" M 11 *Relentless Assault (3)*
"Return of the Witch-king" M 12 *Swarm of Bats (0)*
"Half-orcs and Goblin-men" A 13 *We Come To Kill (7)*
"Olog-hai" A 14 *We Come To Kill (7)*
"Hill-trolls" A 15 *We Come To Kill (7)*
"A New Power is Rising" M 16 *Great Host (7)*
"Many Kings to the Service of Mordor" M 17 *Great Host (7)*
"The King is Revealed" M 18 *Relentless Assault (3)*
"Shadows on the Misty Mountains" M 19 *Onslaught (7)*
"Orcs Multiplying Again" M 20 *Onslaught (7)*
"Horde from the East" M 21 *Deadly Strife (3)*
"Monsters Roused" M 22 *Desperate Battle (3)*
"Musterings of Long-planned War" M 23 *Desperate Battle (3)*
"Pits of Mordor" M 24 *Desperate Battle (3)*

Free Peoples Character Event cards

Fellowship Special Hunt Tiles

"Elven Cloaks" C 1 *Fellowship Special Hunt tile with "0" enters play for the Mordor Track.*
"Elven Rope" C 2 *Fellowship Special Hunt tile with "0" enters play for the Mordor Track.*
"Phial of Galadriel" C 3 *Fellowship Special Hunt tile with "-2" enters play for the Mordor Track.*
"Sméagol Helps Nice Master" C 4 *Fellowship Special Hunt tile with "-1" enters play for the Mordor Track.*

• These cards activate the blue **Fellowship Special Hunt Tiles**. If played before the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track, put the tile associated with the card to one side. Once the Fellowship declares onto the Mordor Track, put all activated special tiles (Fellowship and Shadow) into the Hunt Pool (along with any used Eye tiles). If one of these cards is played while the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track, immediately put the tile into the Hunt Pool.

• **Fellowship Special Hunt Tiles** can only be drawn from the Hunt Pool if the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track (including against Event cards) but are discarded *without effect* if drawn for "Orc Patrol", "Isildur's Bane", "Foul Thing from the Deep" or "The Breaking of the Fellowship" (as is stated on those cards).

"Mithril Coat and Sting" C 5 *"Play on the table" card.*

• Once played on the table, the Free Player may choose to discard this card to set aside the drawn tile and draw a second tile to replace it, but *only* if that tile draw was *by* the Shadow player (whether due to a Hunt or Event card or any other reason) e.g. this card *cannot* be used during "Challenge of the King" Hunt tile draws as the Free Peoples draws the tiles for that card.

• Do *not* put the first Hunt tile back into the Hunt Pool until the *end* of the Action (and note that all redraws must be by the person that drew the first tile; as this card can only act on draws by the Shadow player, then the Shadow player must perform the second tile). Note that "Wizard's Staff" may *not* be used to prevent cards or abilities that cause a redraw (it can only prevent the *original* tile draw) web. Apply the results of the second tile and then put the original tile back into the Hunt Pool.

• Do not rebuild the Hunt Pool if this card draws the last tile in the Hunt Pool, as the original tile that was drawn will be returned to the Hunt Pool *during* this action. The Hunt Pool is only rebuilt during an action if it is empty and a required tile cannot be drawn; in that case, put *all* discarded tiles back into the Hunt Pool, and then draw the additional tile. Finally, return the original tile back into the Hunt Pool. web

• After this card is used and discarded, all normal Hunt steps apply for the replacement tile. Note that "Axe and Bow" or "Horn of Gondor" may also be used against the replacement tile. web

• **Shelob's Lair vs Mithril Coat and Sting.** The Free Peoples player must decide whether to use Mithril Coat and Sting (if it is in play on the table) *before* the Shadow player rolls a die to determine the Hunt damage for the Shelob's Lair special Hunt tile. web

Fellowship Hunt protection cards

"Axe and Bow" C 6 *"Play on the table" card.*
"Horn of Gondor" C 7 *"Play on the table" card.*

• These cards can only reduce Hunt damage, and cannot be used against Events that are not a Hunt (i.e., "Candles of Corpses", "Lure of the Ring", "Morgul Wound", and "The Breaking of the Fellowship" web).

• These cards *cannot* be used against "Isildur's Bane" as although it generates a Hunt, its text specifically requires that all damage must be taken as direct Corruption.

• The Free Peoples player may use only one of "Axe and Bow" or "Horn of Gondor" per Hunt tile drawn.

"Wizard's Staff" C 8 *"Play on the table" card.*

• Once played on the table, the Free Peoples player may choose to discard this card to *prevent* a Hunt tile draw, but only if that tile draw is to be made by the Shadow player (regardless of what the tile draw is for), i.e., Cannot be used after "Mithril Coat and Sting" or "Challenge of the King" (as only tiles drawn by the *Shadow* player can be blocked). web

• Each time there is a required action for Shadow to draw a Hunt tile, the Free Peoples player may decide if he will use "Wizard's Staff" to block that tile draw *before* the Shadow player makes the tile draw. Using this card inside Mordor would result in an effective free move on the Mordor Track (although if an Action die was used to move the Fellowship, that would go into the Hunt box as normal).

"Athelas" C 9

• Can only heal to 0 Corruption (i.e., cannot heal to *below* 0).

"There is Another Way" C 10

• The Event card is used to move the Fellowship here, not the Action die used to play the card; hence, an Action die used to play this card is *not* added to the Hunt box. p37 web

• On moving, roll for the Hunt as normal, and draw a Hunt Tile if the Hunt roll is successful.

• Note that the "move or hide" step is optional (as the card states that the Fellowship "*may* also move or hide"), so this card can be used just to heal 1 Corruption and the "move or hide" step may be skipped.

• Can be played if on 0 Corruption but cannot heal to below 0.

"I Will Go Alone" C 11 *Separate one or more Companions from the Fellowship.*

• Cannot be played if Gollum is the Guide; at least one Companion *must* be in the Fellowship to play (as "Play if at least one Companion is in the Fellowship" is the *condition* required to play this card).

• This card *cannot* be used to move *already separated* Companions. Separate a Companion or group of Companions and move them up to regions equal to the position of the Fellowship on the Fellowship Track, plus the highest level of Companion involved in the move, plus one extra region. Only one group may separate by this card, and they *must* move as a single group, i.e., cannot split off in different directions or pick up or drop off Companions along the way.

• Note that if the Fellowship figure is at a Stronghold where a Free Peoples Army is under siege, Companions that separate from the Fellowship may only ever join that Army and may *not* move further.

• If a Companion leaves the Fellowship due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). p37

• Does *not* permit the moved Companion(s) to move into a Free Peoples Army that is currently under siege inside a Stronghold and does *not* override the rule that Companions must stop if they enter a region that contains a Shadow *controlled* Stronghold (which includes captured Free People Strongholds). p24

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track, but separating Companions from the Fellowship here simply removes them from play (but the Corruption healing takes effect).

• Can be played if on 0 Corruption but cannot heal to below 0.

"Bilbo's Song" C 12

• Can be played if on 0 or 1 Corruption but can only heal to 0 Corruption (cannot heal to *below* 0).

"Mirror of Galadriel" C 13

• Only *one* Action die Character result can be changed into a Will of the West result (and note that it is *only* a Character result that can be changed; this is a commonly misunderstood point).

• It is permitted to use an Elven Ring to change another Action die result into a Character result and then play this card to turn that Character result into a Will of the West result (because using an Elven Ring to change an Action die result happens before *playing* an Action die).

• If a Character result is available when playing this card, it is mandatory to change it to a Will of the West, but if no Character result is available, you can still play this card to perform the Corruption healing (if the Fellowship figure is standing at Lórien, i.e., the first part of the card is not a *condition* to play).

• This card can be used to heal Corruption at Lórien even if the Fellowship has moved on the Fellowship Track; it is the Fellowship figure itself that must be standing at Lórien.

• It is possible to heal at Lórien if it is under siege, but *not* if Lórien is captured.

"Challenge of the King" C 14

• Note that Osgiliath is a ruin of a Gondor city, and so is not a Gondor region (even though Gondor units start the game in this region) so is not a valid region for the condition to play this card.

• If "Eye" tiles are removed from play, that is for the rest of the game. If this happens before entering Mordor, any such removed "Eye" tiles are *not* returned to the Hunt Pool once the Fellowship enters the Mordor Track (unless *three* "Eye" tiles are drawn, in which case, Strider/Aragorn is eliminated, and then return all three drawn "Eye" tiles to the Hunt Pool).

• The card text states, "bearing an Eye", so this also applies in Mordor for the red Shadow Special Hunt Tile "The Ring is Mine!" which shows an "Eye" on it, so that tile may also be permanently removed by this card (which can only happen when the Fellowship is in Mordor and "The Ring is Mine!" tile is currently in the Hunt Pool). For the same reason, "The Ring is Mine!" also applies if three "Eye" tiles are drawn causing the elimination of Strider/Aragorn.

• Do not rebuild the Hunt Pool if drawing all 3 Hunt tiles will leave the Hunt Pool temporarily empty as at least 1 tile will be returned to the Hunt Pool *during* this action. The Hunt Pool is only rebuilt during an action if it is empty and a required tile cannot be drawn; in that case, put all discarded Hunt Tiles back into the Hunt Pool, and then draw tile(s) as required.

• Finally, unless *three* "Eye" tiles are drawn (in which case, Strider/Aragorn is eliminated, and all three drawn "Eye" tiles are returned to the Hunt Pool), any drawn "Eye" tiles are removed from play, and the other drawn tiles are returned to the Hunt Pool. web

"Gwaihir the Windlord" C 15 *Separate from the Fellowship, or move, one Companion or one group of Companions.*

• **If separating from the Fellowship**, move that Companion or group of Companions up to regions equal to the position of the Fellowship on the Fellowship Track, plus four regions. **If moving a previously separated Companion or one group of Companions**, move up to four regions. Only *one* Companion (or one group of Companions) may move or separate by this card, and they *must* move as a single group, i.e., cannot split off in different directions or pick up or drop off Companions along the way. Gandalf the White's "Shadowfax" ability has no relevance here as this card movement ignores Companion levels.

• Note that although this card represents the Companions flying with Gwaihir and the great Eagles, it does *not* permit crossing impassable borders (solid black lines), as per normal rules.

• If a Companion leaves the Fellowship due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). p37

• Note that if the Fellowship figure is at a Stronghold where a Free Peoples Army is under siege, Companions that separate from the Fellowship may only ever join that Army and may *not* move further.

• Moving Companions into (but *not* out of) a friendly Stronghold under siege is permitted by this card (including captured Shadow Strongholds under siege by a Shadow Army). Moving Companions still must follow the rule that they *may* enter, but *must* stop, if entering a Shadow *controlled* Stronghold region. [p24]

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track, but if used to separate Companions from the Fellowship there, they are removed from play (e.g., sometimes done to bring Gollum into play for his Guide abilities).

"We Prove the Swifter" [C 16] *Separate from the Fellowship, or move, one Companion or one group of Companions.*

• **If separating from the Fellowship**, move that Companion or group of Companions up to regions equal to the position of the Fellowship on the Fellowship Track, plus the highest level of Companion involved in the move, plus two extra regions. **If moving a previously separated Companion or one group of Companions**, move up to the highest level of Companion involved in the move, plus two extra regions. Only *one* Companion (or one group of Companions) may move or separate by this card, and they *must* move as a single group, i.e., cannot split off in different directions or pick up or drop off Companions along the way. Note that Gandalf the White's "Shadowfax" ability makes him level 4 *for movement*, but *only* if alone *or* with a single Hobbit, and level 3 otherwise.

• Moving Companions into (but *not* out of) a friendly Stronghold under siege *is* permitted by this card (including captured Shadow Strongholds under siege by a Shadow Army). Moving Companions still must follow the rule that they *may* enter, but *must* stop, if entering a Shadow *controlled* Stronghold region. [p24]

• If a Companion leaves the Fellowship due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). [p37]

• Note that if the Fellowship figure is at a Stronghold where a Free Peoples Army is under siege, Companions that separate from the Fellowship may only ever join that Army and may *not* move further.

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track, but if used to separate Companions from the Fellowship there, they are removed from play (e.g., sometimes done to bring Gollum into play for his Guide abilities).

"There and Back Again" [C 17] *Separate one or more Companions from the Fellowship.*

• This card *cannot* move *already separated* Companions and one or more Companion *must* separate *if possible* (only if Gollum is the Guide is this *not* required). The Companion or group of Companions can move up to regions equal to the current position on the Fellowship Track, plus the highest level of Companion involved in the move, plus one extra region. If a group of Companions is separated, they *must* move as a single group, i.e., cannot split off in different directions or pick up or drop off Companions along the way.

• If a Companion leaves the Fellowship due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). [p37]

• Does *not* permit the moved Companion(s) to move into a Free Peoples Army that is currently under siege inside a Stronghold and does *not* override the rule that Companions must stop if they enter a region that contains a Shadow *controlled* Stronghold (which includes captured Free People Strongholds). [p24]

• Only Gimli or Legolas can activate Nations and advance them on the Political Track with this card, and only if one of Gimli or Legolas is standing at Dale, Erebor or the Woodland Realm after movement (also note that they could have already been standing at those regions before this card was played, i.e., they do *not* need to be one of the Companions separated from the Fellowship). However, this card does *not* permit activating Nations or advancing them on the Political Track by Gimli or Legolas if the region they are standing at is *captured* (i.e., Shadow controlled). [p32] [web]

• Note that if the Fellowship figure is at a Stronghold where a Free Peoples Army is under siege, Companions that separate from the Fellowship may only join that Army and may *not* move further.

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track but separating Companions from the Fellowship there simply removes them from play (e.g., this could be done to bring Gollum into play for his Guide abilities).

"The Eagles are Coming!" C 18

• The Witch-king is unaffected by this card, i.e., do not roll a die for him, and he cannot be eliminated or moved (even if the Shadow player would prefer to move him) because of this card. web

• This is not an "attack" and so does not affect the Political Track in any way. Note that Nazgûl have no Nation (even though they require Sauron to be "At War" to recruit), and can move into Free Peoples Nation regions, and attack or defend with any Shadow Nation Army even when Sauron is not "At War"

• Eliminated Nazgûl return to the Shadow Player's reinforcements and may be recruited in future. Nazgûl that were not eliminated in the affected region must all be moved together (by the Shadow player) to another *uncaptured* Sauron Stronghold (and it must be a *different* Stronghold if the region targeted is a Shadow Stronghold web), including if the Stronghold moved to is under siege by a Free Peoples Army (since, as per normal rules, Nazgûl are permitted to fly into and out of besieged Strongholds). The Nazgûl can only be moved to uncaptured Sauron Strongholds (so Orthanc, Umbar, captured Free Peoples Strongholds, and captured Sauron Stronghold, even if under siege by a Shadow Army, are all also invalid).

"The Ents Awake" Event cards *Gandalf the White must be in play and a Companion must be in Fangorn.*

"The Ents Awake: Treebeard" C 19 *Ents' Rage (3) +2 to Free Peoples Combat roll (but not Leader re-roll).*
"The Ents Awake: Huorns" C 20 *Huorn-dark (3) Shadow rolls a maximum of 2 dice.*
"The Ents Awake: Entmoot" C 21 *Nameless Wood (5) If Free Peoples score at least 1 hit, score 2 more.*

• Gandalf the White *must* be in play and a Companion *must* be in Fangorn, but Gandalf the White does not need to be the Companion in Fangorn. If Gandalf the White is in Fangorn ***or a Rohan region*** when one of these three cards is played an *additional* Free Peoples Character Event card may be played and that can continue until a Character Event card not being one of the above three "The Ents Awake" cards is played (so up to four cards could be played; all three "The Ents Awake" cards plus an additional Character Event card). **Note**: Unlike the **1st Edition** of the game, Saruman does *not* need to be in play to use these cards.

• **If there is no Shadow Army in Orthanc,** then playing any one of these cards eliminates *only* Saruman (if he is present); any Nazgûl or other Minions also present are not affected in any way.

• **If there is a Shadow Army in Orthanc,** then each of these cards is an "attack" and so affects the Political Track. If the Shadow Army is eliminated, so too are all Nazgûl and Minions with it (unlike "The Spirit of Mordor" which cannot affect or eliminate any Nazgûl or Minions in the targeted region).

• These cards can also be played against a Shadow Army that is under siege inside Orthanc or against a Shadow Army that has besieged a Free Peoples Army there.

• If Orthanc is besieged by a Free Peoples Army and these cards eliminate a Shadow Army that is under siege inside Orthanc, the Free Peoples Army captures that Stronghold immediately.

"Dead Men of Dunharrow" C 22 *Move Strider/Aragorn from a Rohan region to Erech, Lamedon or Pelargir.*

• Any number of Companions with Strider/Aragorn *may* move along with him, and this group may even move from inside Helm's Deep under siege, but Army units or Leaders *cannot* move along with him. Note also that Fangorn and Orthanc are *not* in Rohan and so this card is not playable from those regions.

• If a Shadow Army is in the region targeted, then this card is an "attack" and so affects the Political Track. Plus, if the Shadow Army is eliminated, so too are all Nazgûl and Minions with it (unlike "The Spirit of Mordor" which cannot affect or eliminate any Nazgûl or Minions in the targeted region).

• If a Shadow Army is in the region targeted, it is first attacked (rolling one die for damage), and then it must retreat (if it was not eliminated). As per normal rules, an Army may not retreat into Settlement regions

that are enemy controlled (*even* if empty). If the Shadow Army cannot retreat (i.e., no free region to retreat into is available) then it is eliminated along with any Nazgûl and Minions in that Army.

• Recruitment can only occur from the available reinforcements; if there are no Regular Gondor units in reinforcements, Strider/Aragorn (and any chosen Companions with him) still move, and the attack roll (and forced retreat) still happens if a Shadow Army is there, but if the target region is a Settlement (Lamedon or Pelargir) *controlled* by the Shadow, then the Free Peoples player does *not* take control of it. [web]

"House of the Stewards" [C 23]

• Boromir must be standing in a Gondor region (and remember that Osgiliath is *not* a Gondor region). To recruit, the Gondor region must be free; it can be a Settlement or in a region without a Settlement icon (i.e., Drúadan Forest, Erech, or Anfalas), but *not* a Gondor Settlement that is *controlled* by the Shadow player, even if it is empty, as the card does not state that it can *take control* of a Settlement (as the "Dead Men of Dunharrow" card does).

• A Companion cannot move into a Stronghold region where a Free Peoples Army is currently besieged by a Shadow Army and remain outside of the Stronghold; the only way to enter such a region is by use of certain cards (e.g. "We Prove The Swifter") but in that case, the Companion will move *inside* the besieged Stronghold. Hence, it is not possible for Boromir to move to a *besieged* Minas Tirith or Dol Amroth, remaining outside, and to recruit a unit there. [p24]

• Boromir may recruit if he is inside a besieged Gondor Stronghold (Minas Tirith or Dol Amroth).

• Boromir may recruit if he is with a Free Peoples Army that has besieged a *captured* Gondor Stronghold with a Shadow Army inside.

• If there are no units available to recruit, or if Boromir cannot recruit in the current Gondor region (as above), this card may still be played just to draw two Strategy cards. However, Boromir must *still* be in a Gondor region, to meet the condition to play the card. [web]

• Draw two Strategy Event cards (if possible) even if this causes the hand to exceed the hand limit of six cards. If required, discard Event cards down to the hand limit after drawing both cards for this step. If Gandalf the Grey is Guide, and an Event die played this card, draw the two Strategy cards first, then discard (if necessary), *then* draw for Gandalf's Guide ability, and finally discard again (if necessary).

"The Grey Company" [C 24]

• The Elite unit *must* be from the same Nation as the Regular unit that is eliminated (i.e., it goes into casualties, and not into reinforcements). This step can be performed at any region on the board, including outside borders of the Nation of the Elite being recruited, and in Strongholds under siege, including if Strider/Aragorn is with an Army that has besieged a *captured* Free Peoples Stronghold.

• Note that if Strider/Aragorn is with a single Regular Army unit and no other units, the card says to "eliminate" that unit, which might seem to imply that Leaders and Companions with that unit are also eliminated by standard rules, but the intended goal of the card is to *replace* a Regular by an Elite (but noting that the Regular goes into casualties). [web]

• The replacement must be done, if possible, but if no Elite unit is available for any Regular unit in the Army, skip that step *without* eliminating a Regular unit and just draw two Strategy cards. However, Strider/Aragorn must still be with a Free Peoples Army (i.e., the Event card play condition).

• Draw two Strategy Event cards (if possible) even if this causes the hand to exceed the hand limit of six cards. If required, discard Event cards down to the hand limit after drawing both cards for this step. If Gandalf the Grey is Guide, and an Event die is used to play this card, draw the two Strategy cards first, then discard (if necessary), *then* draw for Gandalf's Guide ability, and finally discard again, if necessary.

Free Peoples Strategy Event cards

"The Last Battle" [A 1]

• "Play on the table" cards are removed if their play condition is no longer valid at the *end* of an action. [web] Therefore, discard this card if the Army with Aragorn is eliminated or moves/retreats into a Free Peoples Nation region or if Aragorn leaves the Army (unless he moves into another eligible Army). Note that Aragorn is required to be in play to play this card; Strider is not sufficient.

• This card is removed *immediately* if the Fellowship is declared or revealed. Therefore, if an Action die is used to move the Fellowship and the Fellowship is revealed, then this card is removed first and the die used to move the Fellowship *does* then go into the Hunt box as the very last step (note also that an Action die is *not* put into the Hunt box if an Event card causes the move, e.g. "There Is Another Way"). [web]

• This card can be played if the Fellowship is outside Mordor *or* on the Mordor Track, but a declaration in Morannon or Minas Morgul required to enter the Mordor Track causes this card to be discarded.

"A Power Too Great" [A 2] *"Play on the table" card. Protects Lórien, Rivendell and The Grey Havens regions.*

• Only prevents Shadow Army units from *moving into* or *attacking* the protected regions, ***even*** if those regions are **captured** by the Shadow player or contain Shadow Army units. Therefore, any other action remains allowed, such as, Shadow Armies can move out of (but *not* back into) these regions, Nazgûl or Minions *are* able to move into those regions (if captured, *or* if a Shadow Army is already in that region), and cards that muster/upgrade units into an Army already standing in these protected regions ("Half-orcs and Goblin-men", "Hill Trolls", and "Olog-hai"). [web]

• To discard this card is an Action requiring the Shadow player to use an Action die plus a Character card and an *Army* card (the Shadow player may *not* use a *Muster* card to discard "A Power Too Great"

• To discard this card, the Shadow player must discard "*from his hand*". Event cards that are already in play *on the table* (e.g., "Denethor's Folly", "Balrog of Moria") are *not* in the hand and so cannot be used for this.

• Event cards that initiate a normal "attack" (e.g., "The Black Captain Commands") cannot be played to attack the protected regions (whether from adjacent regions or if the protected region is already besieged).

• Event cards that do not specify an "attack" (e.g., "Dreadful Spells", "Return to Valinor") can still be played against these regions as normal. If a Free Peoples Army is eliminated by such a card, Companions are unaffected. If a Free Peoples Army was besieged inside the Stronghold, the emptied Stronghold is then immediately captured by the Shadow Army standing there.

"The Power of Tom Bombadil" [A 3] *"Play on the table" card. Protects Old Forest, The Shire and Buckland regions.*

• Only prevents Shadow Army units from *moving into* or *attacking* the protected regions, ***even*** if those regions are **captured** by the Shadow player or contain Shadow Army units. Therefore, any other action remains allowed, such as, Shadow Armies can move out of (but *not* back into) these regions, Nazgûl or Minions *are* able to move into those regions (even if no Shadow Army is in those regions), and cards that muster/upgrade units into an Army already standing in these protected regions ("Half-orcs and Goblin-men", "Hill Trolls", and "Olog-hai"). [web]

• To discard this card is an Action requiring the Shadow player to use an Action die plus a Character card and an *Army* card (the Shadow player may *not* use a *Muster* card to discard "The Power of Tom Bombadil").

• To discard this card, the Shadow player must discard "*from his hand*". Event cards that are already in play *on the table* (e.g., "Denethor's Folly", "Balrog of Moria") are *not* in the hand and so cannot be used for this.

• Event cards that initiate a normal "attack" (e.g., "The Black Captain Commands") cannot be played to attack the protected regions (even if from another of the three protected regions).

• Event cards that do not specify an "attack" (e.g., "Dreadful Spells") can still be played against these regions as normal. If a Free Peoples Army is eliminated by such a card, Companions are unaffected.

• Shadow Armies can freely move out of any of the protected regions *except* to another protected region, e.g., moving (or retreating) from The Shire to Buckland is not permitted while this card is in play. web

"Book of Mazarbul" M 4

• This card *cannot* be used to separate Companions from the Fellowship; only Companions already separated can move. All previously separated Companions may move independently up to regions equal to each Companion's level, and/or in groups, with each group moving at the highest level of Companion in that group. Each group of Companions *must* move together, i.e., cannot split off in different directions or pick up or drop off Companions along the way. Note that Gandalf the White's "Shadowfax" ability makes him level 4 *for movement*, but *only* if alone *or* with a single Hobbit, and level 3 otherwise.

• Does *not* permit the moved Companion(s) to move into a Free Peoples Army that is currently under siege inside a Stronghold and does *not* override the rule that Companions must stop if they enter a region that contains a Shadow *controlled* Stronghold (which includes captured Free People Strongholds). p24

• Does *not* permit advancing the Political Track or activating the Dwarven Nation if the Companion ends movement at a *captured* (i.e., Shadow controlled) region. p32 web

• Note that North Ered Luin (which is different from Ered Luin) and Iron Hills are not valid regions to activate and move Politics with this card (only the specific regions mentioned on the card are valid).

• May be played if the Dwarven Nation is already "At War" (just for the Companion movement component). Can be played if "Threats and Promises" is in play but does not meet the condition to cause "Threats and Promises" to be discarded.

"The Spirit of Mordor" A 5

• This is not an "attack" and so does not affect the Political Track in any way; Nazgûl and Minions are also not affected, even if all units they accompany in the region are eliminated.

• If this card eliminates all Shadow Army units besieged inside a Stronghold region by a Free Peoples Army, place any Minions and Nazgûl that were inside that Stronghold in the region with the Free Peoples Army there. The Free Peoples Army then captures that Stronghold immediately.

• Nazgûl and Minions are *not* units so do not count for the card play condition. Playing this card requires specifically *Army units* of different Nations (Sauron, Southrons & Easterlings, Isengard) to be present.

"Faramir's Rangers" A 6

• This is not an "attack" and so does not affect the Political Track in any way; Nazgûl and Minions are also not affected, even if all units they accompany in the region are eliminated.

• May be used if no Shadow Army is in North Ithilien or South Ithilien just to perform the final recruitment action but only if a Free Peoples Army is currently standing in Osgiliath. Note that an Army in Osgiliath does *not* need to contain Gondor units; any Free Peoples Army is sufficient.

• Note that this card can *also* strike a Shadow Army standing in Osgiliath (this option is seldom used). No Free Peoples Army units can be recruited in this case (even if the entire Shadow Army is eliminated) as the recruitment is only possible if a Free Peoples Army is present in Osgiliath.

"Fear! Fire! Foes!" M 7

• This card *cannot* be used to separate Companions from the Fellowship; only Companions already separated can move. All previously separated Companions may move independently up to regions equal

to each Companion's level, and/or in groups, with each group moving at the highest level of Companion in that group. Each group of Companions *must* move together, i.e., cannot pick up or drop off Companions along the way. Note that Gandalf the White's "Shadowfax" ability makes him level 4 *for movement*, but *only* if alone *or* with a single Hobbit, and level 3 otherwise.

• Does *not* permit the moved Companion(s) to move into a Free Peoples Army that is currently under siege inside a Stronghold and does *not* override the rule that Companions must stop if they enter a region that contains a Shadow *controlled* Stronghold (which includes captured Free People Strongholds). p24

• Does *not* permit advancing the Political Track or activating the North Nation if the Companion ends movement at a *captured* (i.e., Shadow controlled) region. p32 web

• Note that Carrock and Dale are *not* valid regions to activate and move Politics with this card (only the specific regions mentioned on the card are valid, i.e., The Shire or Bree).

• May be played if the North Nation is already "At War" (just for the Companion movement component). Can be played if "Threats and Promises" is in play but does not meet the condition to cause "Threats and Promises" to be discarded.

"Wisdom of Elrond" M 8

• The Nation does *not* need to be inactive to play this card; an active Nation will only perform the advance on the Political Track portion of the card.

• Cannot *activate* Rohan if "Wormtongue" is in play (as the "Wormtongue" card states the only conditions by which Rohan can be activated, and "Wisdom of Elrond" is not one of those conditions). "Wisdom of Elrond" can still be used to advance Rohan on the Political Track, but "Wormtongue" keeps Rohan passive so they cannot move to "At War".

• Can be played if "Threats and Promises" is in play, and the chosen Nation may advance on the Political Track, but this does not meet the condition to cause "Threats and Promises" to be discarded.

"The Red Arrow" M 9

• As this card affects the Political Track element, it has been numbered "M 9" in the Strategy deck beside "Wisdom of Elrond", but it is also a generic recruitment card, so see "**Strategy Event cards that recruit Army units**" at the end of this section for recruitment notes relating to this card.

"Help Unlooked For" A 10

• This card triggers a normal *field battle* in all respects, i.e., The attacking Free Peoples Army must contain one or more Army units that are "At War" to start the battle (and Army units that are not "At War" may not participate in the attack). The Free Peoples Army can press the attack for multiple rounds and can advance after combat if possible. The Shadow Army can choose to retreat at the end of any combat round that the Free Peoples player presses the attack (if there is a free region for it to retreat to).

• First calculate the total Shadow Combat Strength (including possible modifiers, this can be up to a maximum of 5). The number of dice that the Shadow player rolls is reduced by 1 for each Army unit that is inside the besieged Stronghold (regardless of whether Regular or Elite Army unit, and regardless of being "At War" or not; Leaders and Companions are *not* Army units) to a minimum of 1.

• If this card was played using an Event die while Gandalf is the Guide of the Fellowship, only draw the new Event card for his Guide ability after *all* Combat rounds in the battle have completed.

"Paths of the Woses" [A 11] *Move one Army from Rohan to Minas Tirith, or to a region adjacent to Minas Tirith.*

• This card follows normal movement rules as if a Rohan region is adjacent to one of the listed Gondor regions, i.e., it does not pass through other regions, it moves directly to the destination. The Army moved could also be in a besieged Helm's Deep as stated on the card.

• You must move to Minas Tirith if possible. If Minas Tirith is captured by a Shadow Army or besieged (even if it is a Free Peoples Army that has besieged a Shadow Army) then it is not permitted to move to Minas Tirith [web] and the Army must move to one of Drúadan Forest, Osgiliath or Lossarnach, if one is free for movement. If Lossarnach is empty but controlled by the Shadow, then it is possible to move there, taking control of that region as per normal movement into an empty but controlled region (this move can be prevented only if Shadow has an Army unit in Lossarnach).

• If the Drúadan Forest, Osgiliath, and Lossarnach regions are all occupied by a Shadow army and Minas Tirith is controlled by the Shadow or is besieged, then this card is not playable.

• The moving Army may be composed of units of any Nation (or may even have no Rohan units at all) and Leaders/Companions in the Army may move with the Army. However, in the rare situation where Elven, North, or Dwarf Army units have *retreated* into Rohan after an attack and are still currently not "At War", they may *not* move to Gondor with this card until their Nation has moved to "At War".

• The Army to move could be besieged inside Helm's Deep. If all Army units move out with this card, the Shadow Army there takes control of that Stronghold immediately; any Leaders left behind are eliminated, but any Companions left behind remain in that region (no longer besieged and able to move freely later).

• The moved Army can merge with a friendly Army even if that exceeds stacking limits, but over-stacking must be resolved back to the stacking limit of 10 units (taking from *any* units in the stack, not just those that moved in, putting back into reinforcements) after all movement completes.

"Through a Day and a Night" [A 12] *Move one Army containing a Companion up to two regions.*

• Select some or all units of one Army containing at least one Companion to move (and at least one Companion must move along *with* the Army). It is not permitted to pick up or drop off Army units, Leaders, or Companions along the way.

• If the Free Peoples Army moves through or into *empty* Settlements controlled by the Shadow (uncaptured Shadow Settlements (including Cities and Strongholds), *or* Free Peoples Settlements controlled by the Shadow player) then take control of any such regions passed through or stopped at. [web]

• The Free Peoples Army can move through or merge with a friendly Army even if that exceeds stacking limits. If so, over-stacking must be resolved back to the stacking limit of 10 units by putting Army units from over-stacked Army back into reinforcements (i.e., the units are *not* eliminated). Do this at the end of the action, after movement has completed.

• Unlike the Shadow Event cards "The Shadow Lengthens" and "Shadows Gather", this card does *not* require the presence of an Army in the destination region.

• The Free Peoples Army cannot move through or over a Shadow Army, or into or out of a Stronghold besieged by a Shadow Army. [p29] [web]

Strategy Event cards that recruit Army units *("recruit" is used for these cards to set apart from muster rules)*

"The Red Arrow" M 9	*Requires Gondor to be Active. Rohan Nation moves forward one on the Political Track.*
"Círdan's Ships" M 13	*Requires the Elven Nation to be "At War".*
"Guards of the Citadel" M 14	
"Celeborn's Galadhrim" M 15	*Draw one Strategy Event card.*
"Riders of Théoden" M 16	*Can recruit inside Helm's Deep under siege, but only if a Companion is present.*
"Grimbeorn the Old, Son of Beorn" M 17	
"Imrahil of Dol Amroth" M 18	
"King Brand's Men" M 19	*Draw one Strategy Event card.*
"Swords in Eriador" M 20	*Draw one Strategy Event card.*
"Kindred of Glorfindel" M 21	*Draw one Strategy Event card.*
"Dain Ironfoot's Guard" M 22	
"Éomer, Son of Éomund" M 23	*Cannot recruit to a Free Peoples Army inside a besieged Helm's Deep (must be "free").*
"Thranduil's Archers" M 24	*Draw one Strategy Event card.*

Points for specific Free Peoples recruitment cards

• **"The Red Arrow".** Gondor only requires to be active; it is not required for Gondor to be "At War". This card cannot move Rohan to "At War" unless it is already active. Can be played if "Threats and Promises" is in play; Rohan will advance on the Politics Track in that case, but this does not meet any of the listed conditions to cause "Threats and Promises" to be discarded. Can be played if "Wormtongue" is in play; Rohan may advance on the Politics Track but may not advance to "At War".

• **"Círdan's Ships".** Note that recruiting to North Ered Luin, Evendim, and Arnor are possible with this card (if a Free Peoples Army is already there).

• **"Riders of Théoden".** This card has specific text that limits recruitment to Edoras or to a Rohan region where a Companion is present, and hence, this card *could* recruit to a Free Peoples Army besieged inside Helm's Deep, but *only* if a Companion is present. This card may also recruit into a *non*-Settlement region (i.e., Eastemnet or Fords of Isen) with a Companion (but only if no Shadow Army is present) but *not* to a captured Settlement with a Companion. Also note that the Leader recruited *must* be a *Rohan* Leader. FAQ

• **"Éomer, Son of Éomund".** This card has specific text that requires a region to be "free" to recruit there. Hence, a Free Peoples Army besieged inside Helm's Deep *cannot* recruit with this card (as is normally possible with other recruitment cards) but *may* recruit to Helm's Deep if a Free Peoples Army has besieged a Shadow Army inside that Stronghold (as the region would be "free" in that case).

Points common to all Free Peoples recruitment cards

• Recruitment by a card is possible at a region when it is free, i.e., the region is either an uncaptured Settlement, or non-Settlement regions that do not currently contain a Shadow Army. It is never permitted to use any of these cards to recruit into an empty Settlement that is captured by the Shadow player or to a region that only contains a Shadow Army (the "Dead Men of Dunharrow" card permits the Free Peoples to recruit into a captured Free Peoples Settlement that is controlled by the Shadow, but this is due to specific text on that card, separate from generic recruitment card rules).

• It is possible for the Free Peoples to recruit by a card at a Stronghold both when a Shadow Army is inside a Stronghold that is besieged by a Free Peoples Army, *or* when a Free Peoples Army is under siege inside a Stronghold (but see the exception for "Éomer, Son of Éomund" above). If recruiting into an Army that is inside a besieged Stronghold to more than the 5-unit limit, first, fully perform the recruitment (to the full extent possible), and then remove units (from any Nation in that Stronghold), placing them back into reinforcements to meet the stacking limit of 5 units.

• These cards may still be played if recruitment is impossible (e.g., if the required Settlement has been captured or if no units are left in reinforcements); just follow the other instructions on the card in that case (such as the card draw for "King Brand's Men").

• For the cards that allow a Strategy Event card to be drawn as the final action, if this is done with an Event die *and* Gandalf, The Grey Wanderer is Guide of the Fellowship, it is possible to exceed six cards in hand. If so, resolve hand size as normal, i.e., discard Event cards until the hand size is six.

• Over-stacking is permitted by a recruitment card, but this must be resolved immediately. e.g., a Shadow Army has captured Minas Tirith but has been besieged by 10 Free Peoples regulars. "Guards of the Citadel" recruits a Gondor Elite unit and a Gondor Leader to bring the total units to 11. A Regular unit (of any Nation) is then put back into reinforcements to meet the stacking limit of 10 units.

• Most Free Peoples recruitment cards have no Political Track requirements, except for "Círdan's Ships" (requires the Elven Nation to be "At War") and "The Red Arrow" (requires Gondor to be active).

• Always recruit to the maximum extent possible if it is not possible to recruit all units listed on the card (due to too few units being available in reinforcements), e.g., if only two Elven units are left in reinforcements when "Círdan's Ships" is played, both units *must* be recruited (choosing to partially recruit, leaving one unit behind in reinforcements is *not* permitted when playing an Event card) to the same coastal region already containing a Free Peoples Army (including possibly to a Stronghold under siege, i.e., Grey Havens, Dol Amroth, or Umbar). [web] **Note:** when recruiting units using an Action die Muster result (and not by an Event card), it *is* permitted to partially recruit. [web]

Shadow Character Event cards

Shadow Special Hunt Tiles

"Shelob's Lair" [C 1] *Shadow Special Hunt tile with "roll a die" and "stop" icons enters play for the Mordor Track.*
"The Ring is Mine!" [C 2] *Shadow Special Hunt tile with "Eye", "reveal" and "stop" icons enters play for the Mordor Track.*
"On, On They Went" [C 3] *Shadow Special Hunt tile with "3" and "stop" icons enters play for the Mordor Track.*
"Give it to Uss!" [C 4] *Shadow Special Hunt tile with "1", "reveal" and "stop" icons enters play for the Mordor Track.*

• These cards activate the red **Shadow Special Hunt tiles**. If played before the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track, put the activated special tile to one side. Once the Fellowship declares onto the Mordor Track, put all activated special tiles (Fellowship and Shadow) into the Hunt Pool (along with any used Eye tiles). If played while the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track, immediately put the tile into the Hunt Pool.

• **Shadow Special Hunt Tiles** can only be drawn from the Hunt Pool if the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track. If drawn against Event cards, they are also applied in full, except for the Shadow Special Hunt Tile "The Ring is Mine!" which shows an "Eye" icon and so is discarded *without effect* if drawn against "Orc Patrol", "Isildur's Bane", "Foul Thing from the Deep" or "The Breaking of the Fellowship" (as is stated on those cards).

• **Gollum's Guide ability to choose to reveal the Fellowship to reduce Hunt damage by one** *can* be used against red Shadow Special Hunt Tiles that do not have a Reveal icon, e.g., this ability can be used against "Shelob's Lair" and "On, On They Went" if the Fellowship was not *already* revealed.

• **Gollum's Guide ability to ignore a "reveal"** *cannot* be used on standard "Eye" tiles *or* "Shadow Special tiles" that have a "reveal" icon ("The Ring is Mine" or "Give it to Uss!").

• **Shelob's Lair vs Mithril Coat and Sting.** The Free Peoples player must decide whether to use Mithril Coat and Sting (if it is in play on the table) *before* the Shadow player rolls a die to determine the Hunt damage for the Shelob's Lair special Hunt tile. [web]

"Orc Patrol" [C 5] *Triggers a Hunt if the tile drawn is not an "Eye".*

• This card cannot be played if the Fellowship is in a Free Peoples Settlement. Note that this restriction applies *even* if the Settlement has been captured by the Shadow player (the remnant of that captured Settlement offers the Fellowship some ability to hide from effects like this).

• A *captured* Shadow Stronghold offers no protection from this card as it is not a Free Peoples Settlement.

• The Free Peoples player may use only one of "Axe and Bow" or "Horn of Gondor" per Hunt tile drawn.

• If a Companion in the Fellowship is eliminated due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). [p37]

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track and drawn "Shadow Special tiles" will affect the Fellowship (ignoring a "stop" icon), but "Fellowship Special tiles" are discarded without effect.

"Isildur's Bane" [C 6] *Triggers a Hunt if the tile drawn is not an "Eye" (all damage must be applied to the Corruption Track).*

• This card cannot be played if the Fellowship is in a Free Peoples Settlement. Note that this restriction applies *even* if the Settlement has been captured by the Shadow player (the remnant of that captured Settlement offers the Fellowship some ability to hide from effects like this).

• A *captured* Shadow Stronghold offers no protection from this card as it is not a Free Peoples Settlement.

• Although this is a Hunt, Corruption *cannot* be reduced in any way, not by Hunt protection cards ("Axe and Bow" or "Horn of Gondor"), or by taking a casualty, or by Gollum's Guide ability to reduce damage. All damage incurred is *direct* Corruption, as meant by "using the Ring".

• Gollum's Guide ability *can* be used to ignore "reveal" icons on standard numbered tiles drawn for this card but cannot be used to reveal the Fellowship to reduce Hunt damage by one as it is direct damage.

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track and drawn "Shadow Special tiles" will affect the Fellowship (ignoring a "stop" icon), while "Fellowship Special tiles" are discarded without effect.

"Foul Thing from the Deep" [C 7] *Triggers a Hunt if the tile drawn is not an "Eye" (random Companion casualty if possible).*

• This card cannot be played if the Fellowship is in a Free Peoples Settlement. Note that this restriction applies *even* if the Settlement has been captured by the Shadow player (the remnant of that captured Settlement offers the Fellowship some ability to hide from effects like this).

• A *captured* Shadow Stronghold offers no protection from this card as it is not a Free Peoples Settlement.

• The Free Peoples player may use only one of "Axe and Bow" or "Horn of Gondor" per Hunt tile drawn. Then, if the damage is still one or more, one or more Guide abilities may be used [web] (e.g., a Hobbit Guide may separate to reduce Hunt damage by one; any new Guide may also then use his Guide ability, including Gollum who may ignore a reveal icon and may reveal to reduce Hunt damage by one when he becomes Guide). Then, if damage is still one or more, a random Companion *must* be picked (note that it is always the Shadow player who performs random Companion draws [p.43]) unless Gollum is the Guide. Any surplus damage must be taken as direct Corruption.

• A "reveal" icon must be applied unless Gollum is the Guide, or if the randomly picked Companion casualty brings Gollum into play, who can immediately use his Guide ability to ignore it.

• If a Companion in the Fellowship is eliminated due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). [p37]

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track and drawn "Shadow Special tiles" will affect the Fellowship (ignoring a "stop" icon), but "Fellowship Special tiles" are discarded without effect.

• **"Worn with Sorrow and Toil"** is always triggered if a random Companion is picked here, since a *randomly* picked Companion during a Hunt is *always* a "casualty" (*even* if he is the Guide and even if he is the only Companion in the Fellowship). If a Hobbit is the "casualty", he can still use his "Take Them Alive!" ability to move up to his level, which is 1, plus the current position on the Fellowship Track, from the Ring-bearers figure position. Guide abilities may be used *before* the random pick as always, and this is important if say, 1 or 2 Hobbits are left in the Fellowship. E.g., Meriadoc is the only Companion in the Fellowship, and "Foul Thing from the Deep" draws a "2" tile. Meriadoc can use his Guide ability to

"*separate* to reduce the Hunt damage by 1", and so he avoids being a casualty, and so "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" will not trigger in this case (the remaining 1 damage from the "2" tile is either taken as Corruption or Gollum could reveal the Fellowship to reduce damage by 1 since he is now the Guide).

"Candles of Corpses" [C 8] *Not a Hunt for any game rules.*

• This card cannot be played if the Fellowship is in a Free Peoples Settlement. Note that this restriction applies *even* if the Settlement has been captured by the Shadow player (the remnant of that captured Settlement offers the Fellowship some ability to hide from effects like this).

• A *captured* Shadow Stronghold offers no protection from this card as it is not a Free Peoples Settlement.

• Any damage must be taken directly on the Corruption Track. This is not a Hunt; damage reduction cards or taking Companions as casualties or Gollum's Guide abilities *cannot* be applied.

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track.

"Nazgûl Search" [C 9] *Fellowship must be on step 1 or higher of the Fellowship Track. Not a Hunt for any game rules.*

• The Witch-king is a Nazgûl for all rules, so he can also be moved and affect the Fellowship.

• Although this is not a Hunt, if this card causes the Fellowship to reveal whilst moving into, out of, through, or remaining stationary in an *uncaptured* Shadow Stronghold, a Stronghold Hunt tile *will* be drawn due to the reveal (a *captured* Shadow Stronghold will not cause a Hunt tile draw).

• The reveal step can happen if the Fellowship is in an unconquered Free Peoples Stronghold, but only if Nazgûl are already there or can be legally moved there (i.e., if the region is under siege).

• The reveal step is carried out by the Free Peoples player, i.e., if a Nazgûl is with the Fellowship after the Shadow player moves the Nazgûl, it is the Free Peoples player that then performs the reveal of the Fellowship figure and, in doing so, may move the Fellowship figure up to regions equal to the current position on the Fellowship Track.

• Cannot be played on the Mordor Track (since the cards play condition is invalid in that situation).

"Cruel Weather" [C 10] *Fellowship must be on step 1 or higher of the Fellowship Track. Not a Hunt for any game rules.*

• Can be used *even* if the Fellowship is standing in a Free Peoples Stronghold or City or Settlement (but the Fellowship must be on step 1 or higher of the Fellowship Track as per the play condition).

• Cannot be played on the Mordor Track (since the cards play condition is invalid in that situation).

• Note that this card permits the *Shadow* player to pick up the Fellowship figure and move it one region from its current location; it does *not* alter the position on the Fellowship Track. This is *not* a Fellowship movement, so cards that require a Fellowship movement (e.g., "Balrog of Moria") are not triggered.

• Note that it is almost always beneficial to the Shadow player to roll for the Hunt, but there can be situations where he may not want to (such as to avoid a reveal that would prevent his use of "Cruel Weather" to stop the Fellowship entering Mordor the next turn). However, Hunt rolls *and* re-rolls are not optional, and Shadow must roll for them when required to do so by a Fellowship move or Event cards.

"The Nazgûl Strike" [C 11] *Fellowship must be on step 1 or higher of the Fellowship Track.*

• If the Shadow player opts to roll for the Hunt (only if a Nazgûl in the same region as the Fellowship), then a normal Hunt is triggered for all purposes, including any Hunt re-rolls; one re-roll for each of: **(i)** one or more Nazgûl; **(ii)** one or more Army units; **(iii)** if the Fellowship is in a region with an *uncaptured* Shadow Stronghold (but *not* a captured Shadow Stronghold), or a *captured* Free Peoples Stronghold.

• The Free Peoples player may use only one of "Axe and Bow" or "Horn of Gondor" per Hunt tile drawn.

• The Hunt roll or discard can happen if the Fellowship is in an unconquered Free Peoples Stronghold, but only if Nazgûl are already there or can be legally moved there (i.e., if the region is under siege).

• Cannot be played on the Mordor Track (since the card play condition is then always invalid).

• Note that it is almost always beneficial to the Shadow player to roll for the Hunt, but there can be situations where he may not want to (such as to avoid a reveal that would prevent his use of "Cruel Weather" to stop the Fellowship entering Mordor the next turn). However, Hunt rolls *and* re-rolls are not optional, and Shadow must roll for them when required to do so by a Fellowship move or Event cards.

"Morgul Wound" C 12 *Requires the Fellowship to be revealed. Not a Hunt for any game rules.*

• Any damage must be taken directly on the Corruption Track. This is not a Hunt; picking Companions as Hunt casualties or Hunt protection cards *cannot* be used here (Gollum's ability to reduce Hunt damage also does not work as the Fellowship is already revealed).

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track.

"Lure of the Ring" C 13 *Requires the Fellowship to be revealed. Not a Hunt for any game rules.*

• After randomly picking a Companion (note that it is always the Shadow player who performs random Companion draws p.43), the Free Peoples player chooses whether to eliminate the Companion or to take direct Corruption instead.

• If Meriadoc or Peregrin are eliminated, they may use their "Take Them Alive!" ability to separate from the Fellowship (as this ability simply says "if eliminated" and not "During the Hunt" like their Guide abilities), hence avoiding elimination (however, if the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track, remove them from play as with all separations on the Mordor Track). If a Hobbit is separated in this way, they can move up to one region away (as they are level 1 Companions) from the Ring-bearers figure.

• If a Companion in the Fellowship is eliminated due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). p37

• "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" cannot be triggered as this is not a Hunt (i.e., a Companions eliminated by this card is not a Hunt casualty).

• Hunt protection cards cannot be used against this card being played as this is not a Hunt.

• Gollum's ability to reduce Hunt damage cannot work as there is no Hunt damage and the Fellowship is already revealed as a condition to play this card.

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track.

"The Breaking of the Fellowship" C 14 *Requires the Fellowship to be revealed. Not a Hunt for any game rules.*

• If the number on the tile drawn is higher than the number of companions present in the Fellowship, the surplus is ignored (i.e., this card does not ever cause Hunt damage to the Fellowship).

• Note that this card requires any separated Companions to be placed in the *same region* as the revealed Fellowship; the Companions cannot *move* as if separating from the Fellowship for this Event card.

• This is not a Hunt so no Hunt-related abilities can apply, e.g. **(i)** "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" *cannot* be triggered, **(ii)** Hunt protection cards (e.g., "Axe and Bow" and "Horn of Gondor" web) *cannot* be used, and **(iii)** Gollum's ability to reveal to reduce Hunt damage also cannot apply both as it is not a Hunt, and because the Fellowship must already be revealed to play this card. web

• "Mithril Coat and Sting" or "Wizard's Staff" may be used against any tile draw by the Shadow player, so can be used here.

• If a Companion leaves the Fellowship due to this card, then the composition of the Fellowship has changed, allowing the Free Peoples player to change the Guide at this point (if possible). p37

• This card may be played on the Mordor Track; drawn "Shadow Special tiles" will affect the Fellowship (ignoring a "stop" icon), but blue "Fellowship Special tiles" and Eyes are discarded without effect (and that includes the Shadow Special tile "The Ring is Mine!"). Any Companions separated from the Fellowship on the Mordor Track by this card are removed from play.

"Worn with Sorrow and Toil" C 15 *"Play on the table" card.*

• Once played on the table, this card can only be triggered during a Hunt (by movement of the Fellowship or by certain Event card conditions that trigger a Hunt, e.g., "Orc Patrol", "Foul Thing from the Deep", "The Nazgûl Strike"), and then only when a "casualty" results from that Hunt. This card *cannot* be triggered if there is no Hunt (e.g. cards that attack the Fellowship but do not use Hunt rules, such as "Lure of the Ring" or "The Breaking of the Fellowship"), or if there is no Hunt damage that requires a Hunt "casualty" to be taken (e.g. if Hunt damage was reduced to 0 by "Axe and Bow").

• **"Casualty"** in game terms is distinct from "elimination" and is only possible due to a Hunt. This card is triggered at any time that a Companion is taken as a "casualty". If either **Meriadoc** or **Peregrin** is the Guide, their Guide ability allows them to separate to reduce Hunt Damage, hence they are not a "casualty" when the Guide ability is used. "Take Them Alive!" ability does *not* prevent them from becoming a "casualty" (they have to be "eliminated" to use the ability, but remain in play in spite of that). Therefore, if a Hobbit can use his Guide ability, then he can separate to reduce Hunt damage (and so is *not* a "casualty"), but for a random pick (e.g., "Foul Thing From the Deep" or the Free Peoples player choosing to take a random casualty), he *is* a "casualty" (and the Guide ability, *even* if he is Guide at the time, cannot be used for a random pick). Note that if Hobbits use their Guide ability on the Mordor Track, they are *still* not a "casualty", even though they are removed from play.

• Note that if this card is triggered, it can remove either a randomly selected Character card from the Free Peoples players hand, *or* a Free Peoples Character card that has been played on the table (e.g., "Mithril Coat and Sting", "Wizard's Staff", "Axe and Bow", or "Horn of Gondor").

• **A randomly picked Companion during a Hunt is *always* a "casualty"** and so "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" will *always* be triggered in this case. This applies *even* if such a Companion is the Guide at that moment. Note that **Meriadoc** or **Peregrin** may still use their "Take Them Alive!" ability to prevent being "eliminated" but this still does *not* prevent them from being a Hunt "casualty" (their Guide ability *would* prevent being a "casualty", but no Companion may use their Guide ability if randomly picked, *even* if they happen to be the Guide at the time), so "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" is still triggered in this case. However, note that a Guide ability may be used *before* the random pick. E.g. If "Foul Thing from the Deep" is played when just the 2 Hobbits are left in the Fellowship, and a "3" Hunt tile is drawn, each Hobbit can use his Guide ability to avoid being a "casualty". Hence, no random pick will happen, and so "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" will not trigger in this case. The remaining 1 damage is either taken as Corruption or Gollum could reveal the Fellowship to reduce damage by 1 with his Guide ability in this example.

• This card may be played (and triggered) when the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track.

• **"Balrog of Moria":** If the Fellowship declares into an uncaptured Free Players Stronghold or City while moving through or from Moria, first discard "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" due to declaring there. Only after this may the "Balrog of Moria" card be applied. Therefore, any Hunt casualties in this scenario *cannot* trigger "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" (since it was already discarded).

"Flocks of Crebain" C 16 *"Play on the table" card.*

• Once played on the table, the Shadow player may choose to discard this card *before* a Hunt roll to give a bonus to both the Hunt roll *and* to Hunt re-rolls; take one Hunt re-roll for each of: **(i)** if one or more Nazgûl are in the region with the Fellowship; **(ii)** if one or more Army units are in the region with the Fellowship; **(iii)** if the Fellowship is in a region with an *uncaptured* Shadow Stronghold (but *not* a captured Shadow Stronghold), or a *captured* Free Peoples Stronghold.

• May be played if the Fellowship is on the Mordor Track but it cannot be triggered while the Fellowship is in Mordor once in play since there are no Hunt rolls in Mordor (which are required to use this card).

• Note that it is almost always beneficial to the Shadow player to roll for the Hunt, but there can be situations where he may not want to (such as to avoid a reveal that would prevent his use of "Cruel

Weather" to stop the Fellowship entering Mordor the next turn). However, Hunt rolls *and* re-rolls are not optional, and Shadow must roll for them when required to do so by a Fellowship move or Event cards.

"Balrog of Moria" C 17 *"Play on the table" card. Discard from play if either of the Event card or Combat card effects are used.*

• If the "Balrog of Moria" card is in play and the Fellowship moves through, from, into or remains stationary in Moria while being *revealed*.
a) Fully resolve the reveal first (i.e. first deal with Hunt Damage, if any, and then reveal the Fellowship, moving the Ring-bearers figure if required).
b) The Shadow player may then choose to use any cards or abilities that apply (in the base game, that is only the "Balrog of Moria" card, but the Expansions have other effects that could apply here; note that if the Shadow player chooses to skip this choice, he cannot choose to use the card or ability *after* a Stronghold tile is drawn). If "Balrog of Moria" is used, it causes a Hunt tile to be drawn, apply that using normal Hunt rules, noting that an "Eye" tile is discarded without effect if drawn for this card.
c) A Stronghold tile must then be drawn and resolved for each *uncaptured* Shadow Stronghold region that the Fellowship moved through, from, or into (including Moria) while being revealed ("Eye" tiles are discarded without effect if drawn for Stronghold tile draws). **Note**: although "remains stationary" is not mentioned, it also meets the condition for the Shadow player to use this card (and is an important condition here, e.g., if the Fellowship is standing in Moria and a card like "Orc Patrol" causes the Fellowship to reveal there web).

• If the "Balrog of Moria" card is in play and the Fellowship *declares* through, from, into, or remains stationary in Moria at the start of a turn.
a) Fully resolve the declaration first (if this is into an *uncaptured* Free Peoples City or Stronghold, then heal 1 point of Corruption, and discard any relevant cards, e.g. "Worn with Sorrow and Toil" or "Flocks of Crebain", if in play; and note that the City or Stronghold healing always happens *first* and cannot be applied *after* a Hunt tile from "Balrog of Moria"; thematically, it might seem that the encounter with the Balrog in Moria should happen *before* the Fellowship reaches the City or Stronghold, but this order is required for game mechanics consistency). A declaration into Mordor is also fully resolved first, and then the "Balrog of Moria" card is applied before the Hunt Pool is refilled for entering Mordor.
b) The Shadow player may then choose to discard the "Balrog of Moria" card to draw and resolve a Hunt tile, noting that an "Eye" tile is discarded without effect. If the Hunt tile has a Reveal icon, there are two cases, **(i)** if the declaration is into a Free Peoples City or Stronghold, then the Reveal icon is *ignored* (note that this applies *even* if the Settlement has been captured by the Shadow player; the remnant of that captured Settlement offers the Fellowship some protection in this case), or **(ii)** if the Fellowship has been declared in any other region, the Reveal icon is resolved as normal which can lead to Stronghold tiles. i.e., Moria is unconquered the Shadow player draws an additional Hunt tile, plus one extra tile for each *unconquered* Shadow Stronghold the Fellowship moved through during the declaration. Note that although it would not seem to have any benefit in doing so, if the Ring-bearers figure is standing in Moria, the Free Peoples player may choose to declare there at the start of a turn while *remaining stationary* (i.e., at zero on the Fellowship Track), allowing the Shadow player to use the in play "Balrog of Moria" card. **(iii)** If the Fellowship moves from or through Moria during a declaration into Mordor, the Shadow player may discard the "Balrog of Moria" card from the table, to draw a Hunt tile. Apply it fully. If this reveals the Fellowship, draw an additional Stronghold tile for each *unconquered* Shadow Stronghold passed through or into (e.g., normally one for Moria, and then one for Minas Morgul or Morannon used to enter Mordor). Apply each fully in turn. Only *after* this is done is the Hunt Pool refilled for Mordor.

• Always make the choice on using this card *before* any Stronghold tiles. If Moria is *uncaptured*, and the Fellowship is revealed, either by a Hunt or another effect (e.g., "Nazgûl Search"), any possible Stronghold Hunt tiles are always after the choice to use this card. p41 If Moria is *captured* while the Fellowship moves from or through that region however, the "Balrog of Moria" card *can* still be used, but a Stronghold Hunt tile will not apply for Moria, even if the "Balrog of Moria" tile causes the Fellowship to be revealed.

• Note: If the Fellowship declares into an *uncaptured* Free Peoples Stronghold, then *nothing* can reveal them while that Stronghold remains uncaptured. For example, the Fellowship is in Rivendell and declares from there into Lórien via Moria at the start of a turn while Gollum is the Guide (i.e., all other Companions have left). The Shadow player chooses to use the "Balrog of Moria" card and draws a "2" Hunt tile. As

the Fellowship has already declared into an uncaptured Free Peoples Stronghold, Gollum is *not permitted* to use his Guide ability to reduce Hunt damage by one to reveal the Fellowship in that region. [web]

• Once played on the table, you can either use the Combat card effect ("Durin's Bane"), ***or*** the Event card effect ("Balrog of Moria"), but the card is discarded from play as soon as one of these effects is used.

• Once played on the table, the Shadow player may *not* use this card to discard "A Power Too Great" or "The Power of Tom Bombadil", as those cards state that the discarded cards must be "*from his hand*" and once this card is played on the table it is no longer in the Shadow player's hand.

• If declaring into Mordor at the start of a turn where the Fellowship moves from or through Moria, the Shadow player may choose to discard the "Balrog of Moria" card from the table, to draw a Hunt tile and apply it. If this reveals the Fellowship, then draw a Stronghold tile for each *unconquered* Shadow Stronghold passed through. Apply each in turn. Only *after* this is the Hunt Pool refilled for Mordor.

"The Lidless Eye" C 18

• The Action die used to play this card cannot be put into the Hunt box. Note that passing conditions may be affected by this as the Shadow may now have less dice than the Free Peoples player.

• **Related note:** The only other way apart from this card to add a Shadow Action die to the Hunt box *after* they are rolled at the start of a turn is for the Shadow player to use one Elven Ring to change an unused Action die to an "Eye" (and only one Action die may be changed to an "Eye" per turn). Note that use of an Elven Ring is *not* an Action, so he must then continue his Action by using another Action die to play an Action *or* may pass (if that is possible). Note that an Elven Ring *cannot* be used to change an "Eye" in the Hunt box into another die.

"Dreadful Spells" C 19

• The Witch-king is a Nazgûl for all rules and, although he happens to have a Leadership of 2, he is a single Nazgûl so only provides one die for his presence when playing this card.

• This is not an "attack" and so does not affect the Political Track or Companions in any way. If all Army units are eliminated, also eliminate all Leaders (since Leaders cannot stand outside of an Army), but Companions are unaffected and remain in that region.

• This is not an "attack" or battle, so there is no redraw for the Witch-king "Sorcerer" ability.

• If this card is used against a Stronghold region where a Free Peoples Army is besieged inside, and it eliminates all Free Peoples Army (and Leader) units, place any Companions that were inside the besieged Stronghold with the Shadow Army. The Free Peoples Army that was inside the besieged Stronghold is eliminated and the Shadow Army captures that Stronghold immediately.

• The Nazgûl do not need to have to be with the Shadow Army that is currently besieging a Stronghold to use this card against a Free Peoples Army besieged inside. Similarly, if Nazgûl are besieged inside a Stronghold with a Shadow Army, this card could be used against an adjacent region, and not just against the Free Peoples Army that has besieged the Shadow Army in that Stronghold.

"Grond, Hammer of the Underworld" C 20

• Playing this card is as an "attack" for all purposes such as the Political Track.

• The Witch-king must be *with* the Army to play this card, but he may be kept in a rearguard (which must be at least one Army unit and any number of Nazgûl and Minions) and not participate in the battle.

• Even if the Witch-king is eliminated during the battle, the Shadow player cannot choose to end the battle earlier and *must* complete at least the three required Combat rounds (unless either Army is eliminated in which case the battle ends immediately).

• After the third round has been completed, the Shadow player can choose to stop or to continue the attack against the Stronghold as normal by reducing an Elite unit to a Regular each time he presses.

• If this card is played using an Event die while "The Palantír of Orthanc" is in play, only draw the new Event card after *all* Combat rounds in the battle have completed.

"The Palantír of Orthanc" C 21 *"Play on the table" card.*

• Playing this card onto the table with an Event die does *not* allow the Shadow player to draw an Event card; it can only be triggered on Actions *after* the card is already in play on the table. web

• Once played on the table, the Event card draw is only possible when an *Event* die is used to play an Event card, and the draw may be from *either* deck, regardless of the type of Event card that was played.

• To discard this card is an Action that requires the Free Peoples player to use either an Elven Ring *and* any Action die *or* to use a "Will of the West" Action die. If using an Elven Ring, that ring is given to the Shadow player and is considered a "use" of an Elven Ring, meaning that the Free Peoples player cannot use another Elven Ring in the same turn. web

• The new Event card may not be drawn before the played Event card has been *fully* resolved. i.e., This is important for "attack" cards ("Grond, Hammer of the Underworld", "The Black Captain Commands", "The Ringwraiths are Abroad", "The Fighting Uruk-hai", "Corsairs of Umbar"), for which all rounds in such a battle *must* be completed before the additional Event card is drawn for "The Palantír of Orthanc".

• If the Shadow player plays an "attack" Event card with an Event die and Saruman is eliminated during this Action, then "The Palantír of Orthanc" is immediately removed from play and there will be no Event card draw at the end of this Action.

• **The Witch-king's "Sorcerer" ability** and "The Palantír of Orthanc" can work at the same time. If "The Palantír of Orthanc" is triggered by using an Event die to play a Shadow Event card that initiates a battle, and if the Witch-king is in that battle and uses a Combat card on the first Combat round, the Shadow player may redraw for "Sorcerer". Then, after the *entire* Action is complete, he may redraw for the "Palantír of Orthanc". If the battle only lasts one Combat round, then the Shadow player draws two Event card draws (firstly, from the "Sorcerer" ability, and then from "The Palantír of Orthanc").

"Wormtongue" C 22 *"Play on the table" card.*

• Once played on the table, Rohan cannot be activated (and hence cannot move to "At War") except by a Shadow Army *attacking* Helm's Deep or Edoras, or by the Fellowship being declared in, or a Companion capable of activating Rohan ending their movement in, Edoras or Helm's Deep.

• "Wisdom of Elrond" cannot activate Rohan while this card is in play (as the "Wormtongue" card text states the only actions that can activate Rohan), but may still advance Rohan on the Political Track, if possible.

• "The Red Arrow" can be played if "Wormtongue" is in play; Rohan may advance on the Politics Track normally but may not advance to "At War" while Rohan is not active due to "Wormtongue".

• If this card is already in play on the table when the Witch-king enters play, do not activate Rohan and "Wormtongue" remains in play (the "Wormtongue" card text states the actions that can activate Rohan).

• If a Shadow Army *moves* into an empty/uncaptured Helm's Deep or Edoras, "Wormtongue" is not discarded as a "movement" is not an "attack". Rohan cannot move to "At War" in this case (though Rohan may move on the Political Track) and "Wormtongue" will remain in play.

• The Fellowship or Companions that can activate Rohan at a City or Stronghold (Meriadoc, Pippin, either Gandalf version, Aragorn, but *not* Strider) *cannot* do so if that region is *controlled* by the Shadow. p.34 web

• If a Companion that can activate Rohan *retreats* into an unconquered Helm's Deep or Edoras (including by use of the "Scouts" Combat card), then Rohan will *not* be activated, as it is not a *move*, so Rohan will not activate, and Wormtongue will remain in play. However, if the Free Peoples Player later uses an Action to *move* Companion (or moves the Army that Companion is with) even if he moves 0 regions and stays in

Helm's Deep or Edoras (and even if they are under siege in Helm's Deep and so *cannot* move), then an Action happened where *a movement ended* in Helm's Deep or Edoras, and so Rohan will be activated by that Companion's ability, and "Wormtongue" will be removed from play. [web]

As soon as Saruman is eliminated, Wormtongue must be discarded. When this happens, there may be some consequences. **(i)** If a Shadow Army unit is already in a Rohan region, Rohan will not activate. However, from this point on, any movement of a Shadow Army moving into a Rohan region will cause Rohan to activate, including into regions already controlled by the Shadow or occupied by a Shadow Army (see the first point in "Activating the Free Peoples Nations" [p34] of the rulebook, which doesn't mention who owns the region the Army is moving into), or cards like "Shadows Gather" are played. However, this doesn't apply if an Army is retreating into or from a Rohan region. [web] **(ii)** If the Witch-king is already in play, Rohan doesn't become active (the Witch-king only activates Nations when he enters play). **(iii)** If "Wormtongue" is discarded during a battle, its effect stops immediately and no longer applies at the end of the action, when the reactions on the Political Track occur, e.g., if a Shadow Army from Orthanc with Saruman attacks Fords of Isen. If Wormtongue is eliminated during the battle (e.g., due to "Blade of Westernesse"), Rohan will become active at the end of the battle, when a Nation that has been attacked activates and advances on the Political Track, as Wormtongue is no longer in effect.

"The Ringwraiths are Abroad" [C 23]

• The Witch-king is a Nazgûl for all rules, so he can be moved when moving all Nazgûl. The Mouth of Sauron is *not* a Nazgûl, so may not be moved with this card.

• If used to "move" Armies, it is permitted to move into and merge with a friendly Army even if that exceeds stacking limits, but over-stacking must be resolved down to 10 units after all movement completes.

• If used to "attack", follow all normal attack rules, including those regarding the Political Track.

• If this card was played using an Event die while "The Palantír of Orthanc" is in play and a battle was initiated, only draw the new Event card after *all* Combat rounds in the battle have completed.

"The Black Captain Commands" [C 24]

• The Witch-king is a Nazgûl for all rules, so he can be moved when moving all Nazgûl. The Mouth of Sauron is *not* a Nazgûl, so may not be moved with this card.

• The second part of the card (move or attack) is *not* mandatory, since it says, "you *may* move or attack".

• If used to "move" an Army, the Witch-king must go with the Army units being moved, and it is permitted to move into and merge with a friendly Army even if that exceeds stacking limits, but over-stacking must be resolved down to 10 units after all movement completes.

• If used to "attack", follow all normal attack rules, including those involving rearguards and the Political Track and rearguards, with the exception that the Witch-king himself must be *with* the attacking force (i.e. cannot be held in a rearguard) as stated on the card.

• If this card was played using an Event die while "The Palantír of Orthanc" is in play and a battle was initiated, only draw the new Event card after *all* Combat rounds in the battle have completed.

Shadow Strategy Event cards

"Return to Valinor" A 1

• This is not an "attack" and so does not affect the Political Track or Companions in any way. If all Army units are eliminated, also eliminate any Leaders with them (since Leaders cannot be outside of an Army), but Companions remain unaffected.

• Note that if any Elven Stronghold regions are currently under siege (either a Free Army besieged by a Shadow Army *or* a captured Elven Stronghold besieged by a Free Army), do *not* roll for those regions.

• Only Elven Nation units can be counted to determine how many dice to roll per Stronghold, and the Free People player may *only* select Elven units in those regions to resolve any damage. web

"The Fighting Uruk-hai" A 2

• Playing this card counts as an "attack" for all purposes such as the Political Track.

• At least one Isengard unit must be *with* the Army to play this card, but all Isengard units could be held in a rearguard (of at least one Army unit plus optionally any Nazgûl and Minions) and not be in the battle.

• Even if Saruman or all Isengard units in the attacking force are eliminated during the battle, the Shadow player cannot choose to end the battle earlier and *must* complete at least the three required Combat rounds (unless either Army is eliminated in which case the battle ends immediately).

• After the third round has completed, the Shadow player may choose to stop or to continue the attack against the Stronghold as normal by reducing an Elite unit to a Regular each time he presses.

• If this card is played using an Event die while "The Palantír of Orthanc" is in play, only draw the new Event card after *all* Combat rounds in the battle have completed.

"Denethor's Folly" A 3 *"Play on the table" card.*

• This card may *not* be played if a Shadow Army is besieged inside Minas Tirith.

• If a Free Peoples Army outside of Minas Tirith (e.g. in Osgiliath) attacks a Shadow Army besieging Minas Tirith, that Free Peoples Army *also* may not use Combat cards while this card is in play. web

• Only a Free Peoples *Leader* (of any Nation) from the Minas Tirith region can be eliminated (if possible). Although Companions have Leadership, they are *not* Leaders and so cannot be eliminated by this card.

• Since "Play on the table" cards are removed if their play condition is no longer valid, this card is discarded if Minas Tirith is no longer under siege (whether it has been captured by the Shadow player or not).

• To discard this Event card from the table is an Action that requires the Free Peoples player to use a Will of the West Action die, *or* alternatively using any Action die, but *only* if Gandalf (either the Grey or the White) or Aragorn (but *not* Strider) is with the Free Peoples Army that is besieged inside Minas Tirith.

• Once played on the table, the Shadow player may *not* use this card to discard "A Power Too Great" or "The Power of Tom Bombadil", as those cards state that the discarded cards must be "*from his hand*" and once this card is played on the table it is no longer in the Shadow player's hand.

"The Day Without Dawn" A 4

• The Action die Will of the West results discarded by this card are only discarded for the remainder of the current turn and return at the next turns Action Dice Recover phase.

• **Note:** If the Free Peoples player rolls 2 or more Will of the West die results in his Action Roll and is concerned that the Shadow player may have this card in hand, he could counter by using an Elven ring to change a Will of the West to another die result. Using an Elven Ring to change an Action die result is *not*

an Action in itself, so he can then play an Action die result and is not compelled to use the die changed by the Elven Ring; hence, after changing the first die result, he could then use another Will of the West with his first Action, and in this way, protect 2 dice from the possible threat of "The Day Without Dawn".

"Threats and Promises" M 5 *"Play on the table" card.*

• As written, this card is *only* removed by **(i)** an *attack* that *advances* the Political Track, *or* **(ii)** by a Companion ability that *advances* the Political Track (which is only possible with Boromir, Legolas, or Gimli who can use any Action die to *advance* their home Nation on the Political Track, but only if they are standing in an uncaptured City or Stronghold of their home Nation).

• Note that *none* of the following cause "Threats and Promises" to be discarded: the Witch-king entering play (Nations will be activated but this card remains in play); playing "Wisdom of Elrond", "Book of Mazarbul", "Fear! Fire! Foes!", "The Red Arrow", or "There and Back Again"; using Strider's "Heir to Isildur" ability; attacking a Nation that is *already* at war, or if a Nation *cannot* move on the Political Track which is possible if "Wormtongue" is in play and Rohan cannot move to "At War" on the Political Track; declaring the Fellowship in an uncaptured Free Peoples City or Stronghold.

• If a Free Peoples Nation *advances* on the Political Track due to an attack, remove "Threats and Promises" with the following exception: if "Wormtongue" is in play and Rohan is one step from "At War" then an attack on Rohan (except for Halm's Deep and Edoras as noted on the "Wormtongue" card) will block the advance (Rohan cannot move to "At War" and stays passive in this case) in which case "Threats and Promises" remains in play.

• "The Red Arrow" can be played if "Threats and Promises" is in play; Rohan will advance on the Politics Track, but this does not meet any of the listed conditions to cause "Threats and Promises" to be discarded.

• Once played on the table, the Shadow player may *not* use this card to discard "A Power Too Great" or "The Power of Tom Bombadil", as those cards state that the discarded cards must be "*from his hand*" and once this card is played on the table it is no longer in the Shadow player's hand.

• Using the Free Peoples Action token (from Hunt for the Ring) that advances a Free Peoples Nation on the Political Track is the same as using a Muster Action die result for the same purpose (see Hunt for the Ring rules, p. 37); therefore, if "Threats and Promises" is in play, it is not possible to advance a passive Free Peoples Nation on the Political Track using the aforementioned Action token. web

"Stormcrow" M 6

• If there are multiple valid Free Peoples Nations that can be targeted, the Shadow Player chooses the Nation that will be moved back one step on the Political Track

• The Free Peoples player decides on the Leader or Army unit (Regular or Elite) belonging to the targeted Nation to eliminate (from *anywhere* on the board). This elimination is not considered an "attack" for any purpose, including the Political Track. Note that it is highly unlikely for the Free Peoples to choose an Elite, but this text is consistent with other cards.

"Shadows Gather" A 7 *Move one Army up to three regions.*

• If a Shadow Army moves into or through any empty Settlements (i.e., considered "free for the purposes of Army movement") then the Shadow player takes control of those regions. This applies to both empty and uncaptured Free Peoples Settlements (including Cities and Strongholds) and to empty Shadow Settlements (including Cities and Strongholds) that are currently controlled by the Free Peoples.

• The destination region *must* contain a Shadow Army; unconquered/empty Shadow Settlements are *not* valid destinations (unless a Shadow Army is at that region). A Shadow Army that is under siege inside a Free Peoples or Shadow Stronghold also cannot be moved to with this card (as the card does not permit moving into a Stronghold under siege).

• An Army can move through or merge with a friendly Army *even* if that exceeds stacking limits. At the end of all movement, over-stacking must be resolved back to the stacking limit of 10 units (taking from *any* units in the stack, not just those that moved). An Army *cannot* move through an enemy Army. [p29] [web]

• An Army cannot end movement in the region that it started from with this card [web]. E.g. If an Army is split and one part of that Army moves using this card, the Army remaining in the starting region does not meet the condition of a region "already occupied by another Shadow Army" (so, e.g., splitting an Army to capture an empty Settlement and then to move back to the starting region is *not* allowed with this card).

"The Shadow Lengthens" [A 8] *Move two Armies up to two regions.*

• If a Shadow Army moves into or through any *empty* Settlements (i.e., considered "free for the purposes of Army movement") then the Shadow player takes control of those regions. This applies to both empty and uncaptured Free Peoples Settlements (including Cities and Strongholds) and to empty Shadow Settlements (including Cities and Strongholds) that are currently controlled by the Free Peoples.

• The qualifying condition "already occupied by another Shadow Army" is established at the beginning of the Action, so one Army may move to a region that qualifies even if the whole of the Army in that destination region *also* moves to another region. [web]

• The destination regions *must* each contain a Shadow Army; unconquered/empty Shadow Settlements are not valid destinations (unless a Shadow Army is at a region). A Shadow Army that is under siege inside a Free Peoples or Shadow Stronghold also cannot be moved to with this card (as the card does not permit moving into a Stronghold under siege).

• An Army can move through or merge with a friendly Army *even* if that exceeds stacking limits. At the end of all movement, over-stacking must be resolved back to the stacking limit of 10 units (taking from *any* units in the stack, not just those that moved). An Army *cannot* move through an enemy Army. [p29] [web]

• An Army cannot end movement in the region that it started from with this card [web]. E.g. If an Army is split and one part of that Army moves using this card, the Army remaining in the starting region does not meet the condition of a region "already occupied by another Shadow Army" (so, e.g., splitting an Army to capture an empty Settlement and then to move back to the starting region is *not* allowed with this card).

"The Shadow is Moving" [A 9] *Move four Armies.*

• Note that this card has a specific difference from "Shadows Gather" and "The Shadow Lengthens" in that it requires *all* Shadow Nations to be "At War" to play. Movement is subject to all normal rules and is simultaneous so you cannot move any part of one Army twice with this card.

• An Army can move into and merge with a friendly Army *even* if that exceeds stacking limits; over-stacking must be resolved back to the stacking limit of 10 units (taking from *any* units in the stack) only *after* all movement has completed, so an Army could move into the same region a seconds Army, and that second Army could move out of that region with this card, to avoid resolving a stacking limit.

"Corsairs of Umbar" A 10

• **Movement must fully complete before determining if a battle starts** (this overrides normal rules as you do not normally move an Army into a region *before* an attack). p28 web **a)**, move all or some of the Army in Umbar (of any Shadow Nations there, plus any Nazgûl/Minions in Umbar as desired) to the chosen Gondor coastal region (move *directly*, do *not* move through or take control of other regions). Umbar must be free for movement for Shadow units, i.e., you may *not* move if a Shadow Army is besieged inside Umbar by a Free Peoples Army (and note that if this is the case, the battle portion of this card is not permitted as Army units *must* be moved for the battle portion of the card to happen), but you *may* move a Shadow Army if it has besieged a Free Peoples Army inside Umbar. **b)** If the chosen Gondor region is empty, take control of that region and activate Gondor on the political track; additionally, move Gondor politics forward if that region is a Settlement (Lamedon), City (Pelargir), or Stronghold (Dol Amroth). If a Shadow Army is already in that region, resolve over-stacking *immediately* (unless the target region is Dol Amroth with a Shadow Army already under siege inside there). **c)** If a Free Peoples Army is in the chosen region, a **battle** commences as per normal rules; if the Free Peoples Army is at Dol Amroth and it is free (i.e. a Shadow Army is not already besieged inside there), the Free Peoples Army may retreat into siege as normal (this would immediately end the battle portion of this card). **Note: If Dol Amroth is moved to and a Free Peoples Army is there and not under siege, the Shadow player must show what Army units will move there *before* the Free Peoples decides on whether he will fight or retreat into siege.**

• **Battle. (i) If it is a non-siege battle,** then the attacking Shadow Army may *not* cease the attack; the battle must continue for multiple rounds until one side is eliminated or the Free Peoples Army chooses to retreat (if that is possible). **(ii) If Dol Amroth is moved to and *a Shadow Army is already besieged inside***, only the Army from Umbar attacks, i.e., it does *not* merge with the Shadow Army besieged there. If the Free Peoples Army there is eliminated or retreats at the end of a combat round, the two Shadow Armies then merge, immediately resolving stacking limits if required. web **(iii) If Dol Amroth is moved to and a Free Peoples Army is already besieged inside**, the Army from Umbar *must* merge with the Shadow Army there first, resolving stacking limits if required web, and then the combined Army must attack, except that in this case, the Shadow player *may* choose to cease the attack after *any* Combat round (since it already *controlled* the region for movement before the battle commenced).

• If this card was played using an Event die while "The Palantír of Orthanc" is in play, only draw the new Event card after *all* Combat rounds in the battle have completed.

Strategy Event cards that recruit Army units *("recruit" is used for these cards to set apart from muster rules)*

"Rage of the Dunlendings" M 11	*Requires Isengard to be "At War".*
"Return of the Witch-king" M 12	*Requires the Witch-king to be in play.*
"Half-orcs and Goblin-men" A 13	*Requires Isengard to be "At War".*
"Olog-hai" A 14	*Requires Sauron to be "At War".*
"Hill-trolls" A 15	*Requires Sauron to be "At War".*
"A New Power is Rising" M 16	*Requires Saruman to be in play.*
"Many Kings to the Service of Mordor" M 17	*Does not require Southrons & Easterlings to be "At War".*
"The King is Revealed" M 18	*Requires Aragorn to be in play.*
"Shadows on the Misty Mountains" M 19	*No requirement for Sauron to be "At War".*
"Orcs Multiplying Again" M 20	*No requirement for Sauron to be "At War".*
"Horde from the East" M 21	*Requires Southrons & Easterlings to be "At War".*
"Monsters Roused" M 22	*No requirement for Sauron to be "At War".*
"Musterings of Long-planned War" M 23	*Requires **all** Shadow Nation to be "At War".*
"Pits of Mordor" M 24	*Requires Sauron to be "at War".*

Points for specific Shadow recruitment cards

• **"Rage of the Dunlendings".** If you do not have at least one Isengard Regular unit available in reinforcements, then *no part* of this card can be completed. web The chosen region to move to could also be Moria or North/South Dunland if those regions are free (i.e., unconquered, and not currently besieged

by a Free Peoples Army), but *not* if those regions are captured (unless Moria is captured and a Shadow Army has besieged a Free Peoples Army that is inside Moria, making it a free region, and hence also for recruitment/movement by this card). Move *directly* to the chosen region, do *not* move through, or take control of other regions. It is *not* permitted to move Nazgûl or Minions or non-Isengard Army units along with the moved Armies as the card specifically only allows movement of *Isengard* units (Regular and/or Elite). [web] Note that "adjacent" does *not* include across impassable borders (thick black lines), e.g., Orthanc is *not* a valid region to move to. [p10] [web]

• **"Hill Trolls".** The unit upgrades can occur either in one Army or one unit in each of two separate Armies, but it cannot be used to upgrade any units other than Regular *Sauron* units.

• **"Hill Trolls", "Half-orcs and Goblin-men", "Olog-hai".** May upgrade/recruit units in a Shadow Army that is already standing in a region protected by "A Power Too Great" or "The Power of Tom Bombadil" as those cards have no restrictions against recruitment in the protected regions.

• **"Horde from the East".** The recruitment may only occur in the following regions: East Rhûn, South Rhûn, Khand, or Far Harad, and cannot be played if all those regions are controlled by the Free Peoples.

Points common to all Shadow recruitment cards

• Recruitment by a card is possible at a region when it is free, i.e., the region is either an uncaptured Settlement, or a non-Settlement region that does not currently contain a Free Peoples Army.

• It is also possible for Shadow to recruit by a card at a Stronghold when a Free Peoples Army is inside a Stronghold that is besieged by a Shadow Army, *or* when a Shadow Army is under siege inside a Stronghold. If recruiting into an Army that is inside a besieged Stronghold to more than the 5-unit limit, first, fully perform the recruitment (to the full extent possible), and then remove units (from any Nation in that Stronghold), placing them back into reinforcements to meet the stacking limit of 5 units.

• Over-stacking is permitted by recruitment cards, but this must be resolved immediately by putting excess units back into reinforcements, e.g., Minas Morgul has been besieged with 4 Sauron Regular units inside. "Pits of Mordor" is played to bring Minas Morgul to 6 Sauron Regular units. Then, the Shadow player must remove a unit to observe the stacking limit of 5 units inside a besieged Stronghold.

• Note that most Shadow recruitment cards require certain Nations to be "At War". Only "Many Kings to the Service of Mordor", "Shadows on the Misty Mountains", "Orcs Multiplying Again", "Monsters Roused", and "The King is Revealed" have *no* requirement that their respective Nations are "At War".

• It is never permitted to use any of these cards to recruit into a captured Shadow Settlement or to a non-Settlement region where a Free Peoples Army is standing (e.g., see "Monsters Roused").

• Always recruit to the maximum extent possible if it is not possible to recruit all units listed on the card (due to too few units being available in reinforcements), e.g., if playing "Orcs Multiplying Again" and there are only 6 Sauron Regular units left in reinforcements, all must be recruited, and none can be held back for other purposes (choosing to partially recruit, leaving one unit behind in reinforcements is *not* permitted when playing an Event card). [web] If there are *less* units than required, they need not be distributed evenly, and the Shadow player may recruit to the regions as required up to the limits the card specifies. [web] **Note:** when recruiting units using an Action die Muster result (and not by an Event card), it *is* permitted to partially recruit. [web]

Combat cards ordered by initiative

Combat card initiative	Free Peoples Combat cards	Shadow Combat cards
0 Anti-Combat-card effects	3x "Daring Defiance"	2x "Swarm of Bats"
1 Pre-Combat effects	3x "Scouts"	3x "Words of Power"
2 Pre-Combat roll effects	2x "Charge" 3x "Sudden Strike"	1x "Durin's Bane"
3 Combat roll effects (some additionally affect Leader re-rolls)	4x "Advantageous Position" 3x "Brave Stand" 3x "Daylight" 1x "Ents' Rage" 1x "Huorn-dark" 4x "It is a Gift" 1x "Servant of the Secret Fire" 3x "Valour"	4x "Cruel as Death" 3x "Deadly Strife" 3x "Desperate Battle" 3x "Devilry of Orthanc" 3x "Dread and Despair" 3x "Foul Stench" 2x "Mûmakil" (initiative 3-5) 4x "One for the Dark Lord" 3x "Relentless Assault"
4 Leader re-roll effects	1x "Andúril" 2x "Confusion" 2x "Mighty Attack"	3x "They are Terrible"
5 Post-Leader re-roll effects	1x "Nameless Wood" 2x "No Quarter"	2x "Mûmakil" (initiative 3-5)
6 Pre-Casualty removal effects	1x "Blade of Westernesse" 1x "Fateful Strike" 3x "Heroic Death" 4x "Shield-wall"	2x "Black Breath"
7 Post-Casualty removal effects		3x "Great Host" 3x "Onslaught" 3x "We Come to Kill"

Battle resolution steps

Declare an attack. The attacker (only) may optionally form a rearguard (must be stated now; the rearguard must have at least one Army unit, with optional Leaders/Companions or Nazgûl/Minions as desired). If the defender is in a Stronghold region that they control and that is not under siege, they may choose to **retreat into siege** (the attacker may then move all, some, or none, of his forces into the Stronghold region and the attack ends); or, if the battle is in a besieged Stronghold region, a **siege battle** or **sortie** starts; otherwise, a **field battle** starts. If Gandalf the White wants to use the "White Rider" ability, he may forfeit his Leadership (for the *entire* battle).

Then, follow these steps for every Combat round in the battle: p28

1. The attacker may select a Combat card (or not). Then the defender may select a Combat card. Combat cards are then revealed simultaneously and take effect at their initiative; if tied, the *defender's* card always resolves first. Resolve eliminations for **Pre-Combat effects** ("Charge", "Sudden Strike", "Durin's Bane") *before* Combat rolls.

2. Roll dice for the **Combat roll** (applying **initiative 3** Combat card modifiers as required).

3. Roll dice for the **Leader re-roll** (applying **initiative 3,4** Combat card modifiers as required).

4. Remove casualties. The *attacker* must remove casualties first, noting **initiative 3,4,5,6** cards. *After* casualties, resolve **initiative 7 Post-Casualty cards** ("Great Host", "Onslaught", "We Come to Kill"). If all units in Pan Army are eliminated, also eliminate all Leaders/Companions or Nazgûl/Minions in that Army. If both Armies are eliminated then the *defender* retains control of the attacked region if it is a Settlement (Town, City, or Stronghold). If dual elimination in a Stronghold siege/sortie, a rearguard takes/retains control of that Stronghold.

5. The attacker may "cease". If not, the battle continues to a new Combat round unless the **defender chooses to "retreat"** (if possible). If the defender retreats, the attacker may choose to advance all, some, or none, of his forces into the vacated region (*except* for any rearguard, which may *not* advance). If the **Witch-king** is in the battle during the first Combat round *and* a Shadow Combat card was used, only draw for his "Sorcerer" ability *after* all

choices in the Combat round are complete (i.e. to continue or cease the battle; the possible retreat of the defender; downgrading of an Elite if continuing a siege battle).

Free Peoples Combat cards

4x "Advantageous Position" (3) *Book of Mazarbul* [M], *Kindred of Glorfindel* [M], *Swords in Eriador* [M], *The Power of Tom Bombadil* [A]

• Note that it is the *defending* Army (and that could be a Shadow Army) that must be "inside the borders of a Free Peoples Nation". Also, the Shadow players Leader re-roll is *not* affected in any way.

1x "Andúril" (4) *Athelas* [C]

• "Foul Stench" will cancel this card as it requires Strider/Aragorn to forfeit his Leadership, which cannot be done if his Leadership has been cancelled. [web]

• "Words of Power" will cancel this card if Strider/Aragorn is selected as it requires Strider/Aragorn to forfeit his Leadership, which cannot be done if his Leadership has been cancelled.

1x "Blade of Westernesse" (6) *Mithril Coat and Sting* [C]

• Only a hit from a Leader re-roll can trigger this. If a Minion is present, then a single hit on the Leader re-roll *must* be used to eliminate a Minion (there is *no* option to use it as damage to the Shadow Army in this case), but if no Minion is present, then that hit is used as damage to the Shadow Army.

• The card states *"to eliminate one Minion of your choice"*, so it is the Free Peoples player that gets to select which Minion is eliminated if more than one Minion is present. The card also notes *"participating in the battle"*, so if a Minion is held in a rearguard, then he cannot be selected for elimination with this card.

• "Black Breath" is also initiative 6 but the tied initiative (defender's card is resolved first) is not relevant as even if the only Hobbit in the battle is eliminated by "Black Breath", if the Free Peoples Leader re-roll scores a hit, "Blade of Westernesse" will still activate and eliminate a Minion, if present. [web] [web]

• "Foul Stench" will cancel this card since it cancels the Leader re-roll required for the cards effect.

• "Mûmakil" has an effect at initiative 5 to see if Shadow gets an additional hit. Even though "Blade of Westernesse" redirects a hit to eliminate a Minion, that happens at initiative 6, so a hit used for "Blade of Westernesse" is still counted for the "Mumakil" determination at initiative 5.

• If "Words of Power" cancels a Hobbit, that will *not* cancel "Blade of Westernesse" as only the *presence* of a Hobbit is required for "Blade of Westernesse" to activate.

• "Wormtongue" would cease to have effect immediately if "Blade of Westernesse" eliminates Saruman mid-battle. As a result, it would not be in effect at the end of the Action, which is when reactions on the Political Track happen. E.g., if an Orthanc Army containing Saruman attacked Fords of Isen, and Saruman was eliminated mid-battle by "Blade of Westernesse", then Rohan would be activated as "Wormtongue" is not in effect at the end of the battle when reactions on the Political Track happen.

• If "Blade of Westernesse" eliminates the Witch-king during the first round of Combat, then his Sorcerer ability cannot activate. Similarly, if it eliminates Saruman during a battle initiated by an Event die and an Event card, then "Palantír of Orthanc" will be discarded, and so cannot activate at the end of the battle.

3x "Brave Stand" (3) *There and Back Again* [C], *The Grey Company* [C], *House of the Stewards* [C]

• Only the *number* of Companions present is relevant. i.e., Aragorn's Leadership of 2 is not relevant for this card, and Gandalf the White counts even if he has forfeited his Leadership with his "White Rider" ability.

• "Words of Power" or "Foul Stench" will *not* cancel "Brave Stand" as this card's effect is only determined by the *number* of Companions present.

2x "Charge" (2) *Círdan's Ships* [M], *Guards of the Citadel* [M]

• Hits are scored only at *unmodified* combat odds, i.e., hit on a 5 with this card if defending, or hit on a 6 if attacking a besieged Shadow Army (or a City or a Fortification on the first Combat round). Cards which affect the Combat roll (e.g., "Deadly Strife", "Dread and Despair") do not affect a pre-Combat attack roll.

• Shadow Army units are eliminated immediately at initiative 2 due to this card; this may affect the Shadow Combat Strength and hence the number of dice that Shadow rolls in Combat.

• "Durin's Bane" has the same initiative as this card. Therefore, if Free Peoples are *defending*, then "Charge" is resolved first, and if Free Peoples are *attacking*, then "Durin's Bane" is resolved first. If an Army is eliminated due to the defender's card being resolved first, then the battle ends immediately; this prevents the attacker's card from taking effect as the battle is now over. **Note:** if "Durin's Bane" reduces or eliminates some or all Free Peoples Elites before "Charge" takes effect, the number of dice rolled for "Charge" will alter, as although the play condition made the card legal to play, the effect itself is dependent upon the number of Elites present when rolled for. [web]

2x "Confusion" (4) *Through a Day and a Night* [A], *Wisdom of Elrond* [M]

• Only *unmodified* rolls of "1" on the Shadow player's *Combat* roll count here [FAQ]. These each count as a hit, but against the Shadow Army, and so those die may *not* be re-rolled in the Leader re-roll. Additionally, these hits would count towards the Free Peoples player hits total for cards that consider that (e.g., Mûmakil).

• If the Free Peoples Army is eliminated before the Combat roll (by "Durin's Bane" for example), then there is no roll for "Confusion" because "*A battle ends when the attacker ceases to fight, the defender retreats, or when one or both Armies are completely eliminated.*" [p31]

3x "Daring Defiance" (0) *Gwaihir the Windlord* [C], *I Will Go Alone* [C], *We Prove the Swifter* [C]

• **Note:** It is legal to play this card in a battle where Gandalf the White declares his "White Rider" ability (this ability is declared before round 1 and applies for the *whole battle*) but it will have *no effect* (see below).

• At least one Companion must be present to play this card, but *all* Companions must forfeit *all* Leadership; if *any* part of Companion Leadership is reduced/forfeited (e.g., by "White Rider") or cancelled (but note that effects like "Words of Power" or "Foul Stench" would not cancel leadership with respect to "Daring Defiance", as they have an initiative *after* "Daring Defiance"), then it is *still* legal to play this card, but the card effect will not happen, and Companions *retain* their Leadership in this Combat round.

• This card is *not* optional if played. All Free Peoples Companion Leadership *must* be forfeited, and the Shadow Combat card is cancelled. However, if that is *not* possible (e.g. due to "White Rider"), then no part of the card takes effect (and *no* Leadership is forfeited). If *no* Shadow card is played against this card, then there is no card to cancel, and again, no part of the card takes effect (and no Leadership is forfeited). [web]

• "Daring Defiance" at initiative 0 normally cancels "Words of Power" at initiative 1. However, if Gandalf the White has forfeited Leadership for "White Rider", then "Daring Defiance" is still playable but has *no* effect (since all Leadership cannot be forfeited as part is already allocated to "White Rider") and so "Words of Power" *will* apply (and Companions not affected by "Words of Power" *retain* their Leadership in this case).

• The Companion Leadership reduction does not affect other Leadership present, e.g., if a Free Peoples Army has Leaders and Companions, then the Leadership from the Leaders is still usable for the Free Peoples Leadership re-roll.

• "Swarm of Bats" vs "Daring Defiance". These cards have the same initiative, so the defender's card activates first. **(i)** If a Shadow Army is attacking, "Daring Defiance" activates first (*all* Companions in this battle lose their Leadership for this round), and "Swarm of Bats" is cancelled. However, if Gandalf the White activates "The White Rider" ability that uses his own Leadership, so that although "Daring Defiance" has been legally played (as Companions are in the battle), the Leadership of *all* the Companions now cannot be forfeited; thus "Swarm of Bats" will *not* be cancelled, and instead it will activate and cancel

"Daring Defiance", meaning that the Companions will retain their Leadership in this specific case (which they would not if "Daring Defiance" could activate), and the Shadow Army does not get the Leadership re-roll bonus from "Swarm of Bats". **(ii)** If a Free Peoples Army is attacking, "Swarm of Bats" activates first, cancelling "Daring Defiance", and so Companions will retain their Leadership in this round. web

3x "Daylight" (3) *Celeborn's Galadhrim M, Riders of Théoden M, The Last Battle A*

• Leader re-rolls are also a maximum of 3 dice (as they cannot number more than the Combat dice).

• If the Shadow player has played a Combat card that entitles him to a pre-combat or post-combat attack roll (e.g. "Durin's Bane" or "We Come to Kill"), then that roll is *not* affected by "Daylight".

1x "Ents' Rage" (3) *The Ents Awake: Treebeard C*

• Note that it is the *defending* Army (and that could be a Shadow Army) that must be in a *Rohan* region *or Fangorn or Orthanc* for this card to be played.

• The +2 increase is for the Free Peoples Combat roll and does not affect the *Leader* re-roll in any way.

• If "Deadly Strife" and "Ents' Rage" are played together and the Free Peoples player's Combat roll is 5 or more, "Deadly Strife" is +2 and "Ents' Rage" is +2, meaning hits on a 1 or more (i.e., automatic hits). However, a 1 is *always a miss* p30, so the Free Peoples player hits on 2 or more if these are played together.

1x "Fateful Strike" (6) *Bilbo's Song C*

• The Witch-king is a Minion *and* a Nazgûl for all rules, as a Minion condition is specified on the card, the Witch-king requires two Leadership re-roll hits to eliminate with this card.

• Although the wording is slightly different to that of "Blade of Westernesse", the intent is that the Free Peoples player chooses which Minion or Nazgûl is eliminated if there are multiple options.

• The hits scored on the Leader re-roll that eliminate a Nazgûl or a Minion are *in addition to* the damage they do to Shadow Army units (just to reiterate the "*additionally*" text on the card).

• "Black Breath" is also initiative 6 but the tied initiative rule (defender's card is resolved first) is not relevant here as "Fateful Strike" activates when its play condition is met; the Leader re-roll still takes place, and so "Fateful Strike" applies, even if a Leader or Companion is eliminated by "Black Breath". web web

• If "Fateful Strike" eliminates the Witch-king during the first round of Combat, then his Sorcerer ability cannot activate. Similarly, if it eliminates Saruman during a battle initiated by an Event die and an Event card, then "Palantír of Orthanc" will be discarded, and so cannot activate at the end of the battle.

• "Foul Stench" will cancel this card since it cancels the Leader re-roll required for the cards effect.

• "Words of Power" does not cancel this card *unless* the entire Leadership of the Free Peoples Army is provided by a single Companion who is negated by "Words of Power".

• "Wormtongue" would cease to have effect immediately if "Fateful Strike" eliminates Saruman mid-battle. As a result, it would not be in effect at the end of the Action, which is when Political Track advancement always occurs. E.g., if an Orthanc Army containing Saruman attacked Fords of Isen, and Saruman was eliminated mid-battle by "Fateful Strike", then Rohan would be activated as "Wormtongue" is not in effect at the end of the battle when Political Track advancement happens.

3x "Heroic Death" (6) *The Eagles Are Coming! C, Mirror of Galadriel C, There Is Another Way C*

• Only one Leader or Companion may be eliminated to reduce damage. Note that Gandalf the White is level 3 (he is only level 4 for movement by himself or with a single hobbit) so he can only absorb 3 damage.

• "Black Breath" is also initiative 6 so tied initiatives (defender's card is resolved first) apply here. If the Shadow player is the defender and "Black Breath" eliminates all Leadership from the Free Peoples Army, then "Heroic Death" cannot be used. Conversely, if the Free Peoples player is the defender and "Heroic Death" leaves the Free Peoples Army with zero Leadership, then "Black Breath" cannot take effect. web web

• "Words of Power" does not cancel the use of "Heroic Death" for the affected Companion.

• The "total hits" test on "Mûmakil" is calculated at initiative 5, so "Heroic Death" (at initiative 6) does not influence whether the "Mûmakil" additional hit is applied.

• Older card printings were unclear on which Leaders could be eliminated; newer printings state *"one of your Leaders"* to clarify that it is a Free Peoples Leader (or Companion) that may be eliminated. FAQ

1x "Huorn-dark" (3) *The Ents Awake: Huorns* C

• Note that it is the *defending* Army (and that could be a Shadow Army) that must be in a *Rohan* region *or Fangorn or Orthanc* for this card to be played.

• Leader re-rolls are also a maximum of 2 dice (as they cannot number more than the Combat dice).

4x "It is a Gift" (3) *Elven Cloaks* C, *Elven Rope* C, *Sméagol Helps Nice Master* C, *Phial of Galadriel* C

• Note that the Fellowship must be in the same region as the *defending* Army (and that could be a Shadow Army).

• This card affects Combat rolls *and* Leader re-rolls.

2x "Mighty Attack" (4) *Axe and Bow* C, *Horn of Gondor* C

• "Foul Stench" will cancel this card since it relies upon a Companion forfeiting their Leadership before the Leader re-roll. "Foul Stench" prevents the Leader re-roll so "Mighty Attack" is cancelled. web

• "Words of Power" *may* cancel this card, but only if there is a single Companion in the battle whose Leadership is cancelled; if there is more than one Companion in the battle, then another Companion must forfeit his Leadership for the "Mighty Attack" effect.

1x "Nameless Wood" (5) *The Ents Awake: Entmoot* C

• Note that it is the *defending* Army (and that could be a Shadow Army) that must be in a *Rohan* region *or Fangorn or Orthanc* for this card to be played.

• "Mûmakil" counts hits from Free Peoples Combat cards up to initiative 5, but "Nameless Wood" is also initiative 5. Therefore, "Nameless Wood" is included in the "Mûmakil" count of "total hits" only if the Free Peoples Army is *defending* (since in tied initiatives, the defender's card is always resolved first). web

• There is no limit to the number of hits. e.g. if 5 hits are rolled in combat, +2 would be a total of 7 hits.

2x "No Quarter" (5) *Help Unlooked For* A, *A Power Too Great* A

• "Mûmakil" counts hits from Free Peoples Combat cards up to initiative 5, but "No Quarter" is also initiative 5. Therefore, "No Quarter" is included in the "Mûmakil" count of "total hits" only if the Free Peoples Army is *defending* (since in tied initiatives, the defender's card is always resolved first). web

• There is no limit to the number of hits. e.g. if 5 hits are rolled in combat, +1 would be a total of 6 hits.

3x "Scouts" (1) *The Red Arrow* M, *Grimbeorn the Old, Son of Beorn* M, *The Spirit of Mordor* A

• This card follows normal retreat rules (but *before* battle commences). An Army (even if not "At War") is permitted to retreat across borders (friendly or enemy) including into a *friendly* Settlement (which includes Cities or Strongholds) but may *not* retreat into an enemy *controlled* Settlement. Note that Army units *not* "At War" may not *move* across borders but may *retreat* across borders. Similarly, an Army may *not* retreat into an uncaptured enemy Settlement (including Cities or Strongholds), *even* if empty, except into a Stronghold region that is currently besieged by a friendly Army. p10 ("free regions". See also Appendix in this document, "**Moving and Retreating**")

• If the retreat merges with another Army, then resolve over-stacking immediately by putting excess units back into reinforcements (i.e. do not put them into casualties and they may be recruited later).

• The Free Peoples Army may play this card to retreat into a Stronghold instead of to a different region. This might be done to trick the Shadow player into playing a good Combat card in a field battle for example.

• The Free Peoples Army must be the *defender* in a *field battle*; it *cannot* be played in a siege battle or when the Free Peoples Army is attacking.

• "Swarm of Bats" will always negate "Scouts" as "Swarm of Bats" has a lower initiative (0).

• Note that if a Companion retreats into an unconquered City or Stronghold (normally, or by use of "Scouts"), that is not a *move*, so the ability of Companions to activate certain passive Nations does not work. If the Free Peoples Player later *moves* that Companion (or moves the Army he is with) and he ends movement in a City or Stronghold (*even* if he remains stationary), then that Nation will activate (e.g., see the "Wormtongue" entry for an important example of this if retreating into Helm's Deep or Edoras). [web]

1x "Servant of the Secret Fire" (3) *Wizard's Staff* [C]

• This card simply requires that "Gandalf is in the battle". Hence, "Words of Power" has no effect on this card, and Gandalf may be using his White Rider ability and this card is still playable.

4x "Shield-wall" (6) *Faramir's Rangers* [A], *Imrahil of Dol Amroth* [M], *King Brand's Men* [M], *Fear! Fire! Foes!* [M]

• This card cannot be used to prevent the effect from "Black Breath". If the Shadow player scores one or more hits in the Leader re-roll, those hits all count for "Black Breath" regardless of "Shield-wall".

• The "total hits" test on "Mûmakil" is calculated at initiative 5, so "Shield-wall" (at initiative 6) does not influence whether the "Mûmakil" additional hit is applied.

3x "Sudden Strike" (2) *Challenge of the King* [C], *Dead Men of Dunharrow* [C], *Paths of the Woses* [A]

• Hits are scored only at *unmodified* combat odds, i.e., hit on a 5 with this card if defending, or hit on a 6 if attacking a besieged Shadow Army (or a City or a Fortification on the first Combat round). Cards which affect the Combat roll (e.g., "Deadly Strife", "Dread and Despair") do not affect a pre-Combat attack.

• Shadow Army units eliminated by this card are removed from play immediately which may affect the Shadow Combat Strength or even eliminate the Shadow Army completely before any Combat rolls.

• "Durin's Bane" has the same initiative as this card. Therefore, if Shadow is defending, then "Durin's Bane" is rolled for first, but if Shadow is attacking, "Sudden Strike" is rolled for first. This is important as the casualties are immediate so it may affect how many dice the later card effect will roll.

• "Foul Stench" will *not* cancel this card as it only cancels the Leader re-roll, not pre-combat effects.

• "Words of Power" (initiative 1) will cancel a Companion Leadership *before* "Sudden Strike" (initiative 2). Note this reduction in Leadership when rolling for "Sudden Strike".

• "Durin's Bane" has the same initiative as this card. Therefore, if Free Peoples are *defending*, then "Sudden Strike" is resolved first, and if Free Peoples are *attacking*, then "Durin's Bane" is resolved first. If an Army is eliminated due to the defender's card being resolved first, then the battle ends immediately; this prevents the attacker's card from taking effect as the battle is now over.

3x "Valour" (3) *Éomer, son of Éomund* [M], *Thranduil's Archers* [M], *Dain Ironfoot's Guard* [M]

• Does not affect the odds on the Free Peoples Leader re-roll in any way.

• If the card is played and Free Peoples Elites are reduced or eliminated *before* the combat roll (e.g., by "Durin's Bane"), this card will still take effect as its play condition was valid when played. [web]

Shadow Combat cards

2x "Black Breath" (6) *Morgul Wound* [C], *The Nazgûl Strike* [C]

• This card only requires the *presence* of a Nazgûl. Therefore, if Gandalf the White is in this battle and chooses to forfeit his Leadership for the "White Rider" ability then this card is playable. However, as all Nazgûl Leadership is negated, Isengard Elites (if Saruman is in play), the Mouth of Sauron, or Saruman would be needed to generate any Leader re-roll hits required for this card's effect in that case.

• This effect is "additional" to casualties. Any hits scored on the Leader re-roll eliminate a Companion or Leader (and by card text, chosen *by* the Shadow player) in *addition* to damage done to Shadow Army units.

• "Heroic Death" is also initiative 6 so tied initiatives (defender's card is resolved first) apply here. If the Shadow player is the defender and "Black Breath" eliminates all Leadership from the Free Peoples Army, then "Heroic Death" cannot be used. Conversely, if the Free Peoples player is the defender and "Heroic Death" leaves the Free Peoples Army with zero Leadership, then "Black Breath" cannot take effect. web web

• "Shield-wall" has no effect against this card; hits scored on the Shadow player Leader re-roll all count for the purposes of this card, regardless of any Army unit damage reduction from "Shield-wall".

4x "Cruel as Death" (4) *Cruel Weather* [C], *Isildur's Bane* [C], *Orc Patrol* [C], *The Palantír of Orthanc* [C]

• If Gandalf the White is in the battle and using his "White Rider" ability then this card may *not* be played, since it requires Nazgûl Leadership (which is negated by the "White Rider" ability for the whole battle).

• This card only uses *Nazgûl* Leadership. Ignore any Leadership from other sources (e.g., Saruman).

• This Combat effect is *not* optional, e.g., if played against "Advantageous Position", the Shadow player *must* forfeit 2 Nazgûl Leadership, even though "Advantageous Position" counters this Combat effect.

• "Subtracting" Nazgûl Leadership (as is written on older printings) is synonymous with "forfeiting" Nazgûl Leadership. FAQ

3x "Deadly Strife" (3) *Horde from the East* [M], *Return to Valinor* [A], *Corsairs of Umbar* [A]

• This effect applies to *both* Shadow and Free Peoples Armies and to Combat rolls *and* Leader re-rolls.

• If "Deadly Strife" and "Ents' Rage" are played together and the Free Peoples player's Combat roll is on 5 or more, "Deadly Strife" is +2 and "Ents' Rage" is +2, meaning hits on a 1 or more (i.e., automatic hits). However, a 1 is *always a miss* p30, so the Free Peoples would player hit on a 2 or more in this case.

3x "Desperate Battle" (3) *Pits of Mordor* [M], *Monsters Roused* [M], *Musterings of Long-planned War* [M]

• This effect applies to *both* Shadow and Free Peoples Armies and to Combat rolls *and* Leader re-rolls.

3x "Devilry of Orthanc" (3) *Dreadful Spells* [C], *Denethor's Folly* [A], *Threats and Promises* [M]

• Can only be played when a Stronghold has been attacked in a *siege* battle (i.e., it can *never* be played during a field battle or when a besieged Army has sortied out of a Stronghold; "in a Stronghold" means *under siege*, as distinct from "in a region containing a Stronghold").

• The Shadow Army with the required Isengard unit could be attacking a Stronghold *or* defending from inside a Stronghold, but the defender in the battle *must* be inside the besieged Stronghold. web

3x "Dread and Despair" (3) *Candles of Corpses* [C], *The Breaking of the Fellowship* [C], *Grond, Hammer of the Underworld* [C]

• If Gandalf the White is in the battle and using his "White Rider" ability then this card may *not* be played, since it requires Nazgûl Leadership (which is negated by the "White Rider" ability for the whole battle).

• This card only uses *Nazgûl* Leadership. It cannot use Leadership from any other sources (e.g., Saruman). First calculate the total Free Peoples Combat Strength (including from modifiers like "Captain of the West"

up to a maximum Combat Strength of 5). The Shadow player *must* then forfeit Nazgûl Leadership to reduce the number of Combat dice rolled by the Free Peoples (this is not optional; Shadow must forfeit at least 1 Leadership).

• Any amount of Nazgûl Leadership can be forfeited (even more than the total Free Peoples Combat Strength), but the number of Free Peoples Combat dice rolled can never be lower than a minimum of 1.

• The Leadership reduction does not affect other Leadership present. e.g., If a Shadow Army has 9 Leadership and forfeits 4, they will still have 5 Leadership usable for the Shadow Army Leadership re-roll.

• Does *not* affect Free People pre-combat attacks ("Sudden Strike", "Charge").

1x "Durin's Bane" (2) *Balrog of Moria* C

• The Witch-king's "Sorcerer" ability still applies if this Combat card has been played on the table and is used in the first round of the battle.

• If "Balrog of Moria" was previously already played on the table, and the *defender* in the battle is within 2 regions of Moria, the Shadow player may lift this card into his hand (even if this takes his hand size to 7) so that he has the option to play the card without his opponent knowing which card is being played. If this card is not used in this battle, place it back on the table at the end of the battle. Note that if this card is played *from the table* on round 1, and the Witch-king uses his "Sorcerer" ability, then a Character Event card may be drawn at the end of round 1, meaning that Shadow could continue to have a hand size of 7 in round 2 and onwards. It is only at the end of the battle (the end of the Action) that the Shadow player would be required to discard down to a hand size of 6.

• Hits are scored on rolls of 4 or more; cards which affect the Combat roll (e.g., "Advantageous Position") do *not* alter this (or any other pre-/post-Combat effects) in any way.

• Regions are not connected through impassable black lines, e.g., Rivendell is *not* 2 regions from Moria. p10

• "Charge" and "Sudden Strike" have the same initiative as "Durin's Bane". Therefore, if Shadow is *defending*, then "Durin's Bane" is resolved first, and if Shadow is *attacking*, the Free Peoples card is resolved first. If an Army is eliminated due to the defender's card being resolved first, then the battle ends immediately; this prevents the attacker's card from taking effect as the battle is now over.

• "Charge" activates if Free Peoples Elites are in the battle, but if Shadow is defending and "Durin's Bane" eliminates or reduces the number the Free Peoples Elites, the roll for "Charge" is determined by the number of Elites remaining at the time it is rolled for.

• Any other later card (e.g., "Confusion" at initiative 4) cannot apply if the Free Peoples Army is eliminated by "Durin's Bane" before the Combat roll ("*A battle ends when the attacker ceases to fight, the defender retreats, or when one or both Armies are completely eliminated*" p31) since there will be no Combat roll.

3x "Foul Stench" (3) *Nazgûl Search* C, *The Black Captain Commands* C, *Wormtongue* C

• If Gandalf the White is in the battle and using his "White Rider" ability then this card may *not* be played, since it requires Nazgûl Leadership (which is negated by the "White Rider" ability for the whole battle).

• This card can only be played if *Nazgûl* Leadership is present (including the Witch-king). Ignore any Leadership from other sources (e.g., Saruman) for calculating if the card takes effect.

• This card completely negates "Andúril", "Blade of Westernesse", "Mighty Attack", and "Fateful Strike", but note that "Sudden Strike" is *not* negated (since it activates before initiative 3). web

3x "Great Host" (7) *Many Kings to the Service of Mordor* M, *A New Power Is Rising* M, *Stormcrow* M

• Although Elites can take 2 damage, they are of course each a single Army unit when counting the number of Army units for "Great Host" to see if Shadow has at least twice the number of Army units.

• The Shadow player's Army must be *at least* twice as large in total *number* of Army units after damage has been taken. Note that the *attacker* must decide first on casualties p30, which is important as depending upon

how the Shadow player eliminates Regulars and/or reduces Elite Army units, he may not meet the criteria for this card to take effect.

2x "Mûmakil" (3-5) *The Shadow Lengthens* [A], *Shadows Gather* [A]

• There are two distinct effects, the +1 to combat roll happens at initiative 3, and the check if Shadow scored more total hits happens at initiative 5 (immediately after the Leader re-roll).

• "Blade of Westernesse" "uses a hit" to eliminate a Minion at initiative 6, but the count for "Mûmakil" (to see if Shadow gets an additional hit) happens at initiative 5, i.e., even though that Free Peoples hit is redirected to eliminate a Minion, it is still counted for the "Mumakil" additional hit determination.

• If "Charge" or "Sudden Strike" cause all Southron & Easterlings Elites to be eliminated (casualties are decided by the Shadow player but he may choose to reduce/eliminate these Elites), the "Mûmakil" effect still applies as the play condition was met (i.e. the effects at initiative 3 and 5 both apply). web

• "Confusion" hits due to "1" results on the Shadow players Combat roll count toward the total hits for the *Free Peoples* player for "Mûmakil" (since those hits are the result of a Free Peoples Combat card). web

• "Nameless Wood", "No Quarter" (both initiative 5) hits are included in the "total hits" count of whether "Mûmakil" does an additional hit *only* if the Free Peoples Army is *defending* (because in tied initiatives, the defender's card is resolved first). If the Free Peoples Army is attacking, additional hits from these cards are not counted to the "total hits" for whether "Mûmakil" scores an additional hit or not. web

• "Shield-wall" cannot be relevant when calculating if the additional hit from "Mûmakil" will be applied because the "total hits" test is calculated at initiative 5, and "Shield-wall" does not take effect until initiative 6. However, note that the "total hits" count *includes* pre-combat effects like "Charge" or "Sudden Strike".

• **Note:** The wording of this card has been altered slightly to address timing issues (the following text overrides earlier printings of the game): *"If, after the Leader re-roll, you scored more total hits than your opponent (including effects from any Free Peoples Combat card), score one additional hit."* web

4x "One for the Dark Lord" (3) *Give it to Uss!* [C], *On, On They Went* [C], *The Ring is Mine!* [C], *Shelob's Lair* [C]

• Note that the Fellowship must be in the same region as the *defending* Army, and that this card affects the Shadow Players Combat rolls *and* Leader re-rolls. It does not benefit the Free Peoples Army, unlike "Desperate Battle" or "Deadly Strife".

3x "Onslaught" (7) *Orcs Multiplying Again* [M], *Shadows on the Misty Mountains* [M], *The Fighting Uruk-hai* [M]

• This is a post-combat attack; there is no Leader re-roll on the dice rolled by this card. Hits are scored only on rolls of 4 or more. Cards which affect the Combat roll (e.g., "Advantageous Position", "Daylight") do *not* affect this attack (or any other pre-/post-combat attacks) in any way. If the Free Peoples Army is eliminated in doing this, any Companions with that Army are also eliminated.

• Only units present in the current battle may be eliminated (e.g., units in a rearguard cannot be used). The Shadow player may eliminate all units in the Shadow Army for this card effect, and if so any Nazgûl or Minions with that Army are also eliminated. If the Free Peoples Army is also eliminated in doing this, the region attacked remains under the control of whoever controlled it before the battle. p32 web

3x "Relentless Assault" (3) *The King is Revealed* [M], *The Rage of the Dunlendings* [M], *The Day Without Dawn* [A]

• This card only affects Combat rolls. Only units present in the current battle may be eliminated (e.g., units in a rearguard cannot be used).

• Eliminating all units in the Shadow Army is possible with this card but is also completely counter-productive (and all accompanying Nazgûl or Minions would be eliminated immediately also). web

2x "Swarm of Bats" (0) *The Shadow Is Moving* [A], *Return of the Witch-king* [M]

• "Daring Defiance" vs "Swarm of Bats". These cards have the same initiative, so the *defender's* card activates first. If a Free Peoples Army is defending, "Daring Defiance" activates first (*all* Companions lose their Leadership for this round), and "Swarm of Bats" is cancelled, *unless* Gandalf the White is using his "White Rider" ability in which case "Daring Defiance" has no effect (if Gandalf already forfeited Leadership for "White Rider" then *all* Companions cannot forfeit Leadership for "Daring Defiance"), but the card is still legally playable (since Companions are in the battle), so "Swarm of Bats" is able to activate next and it will cancel "Daring Defiance"; Companions retain their Leadership in this case and the Shadow Army does not get the Leadership bonus from "Swarm of Bats". If a Shadow Army is defending, "Swarm of Bats" activates first, cancelling "Daring Defiance"; Companions retain their Leadership in this case also. web

3x "They are Terrible" (4) *Flocks of Crebain* [C], *Foul Thing from the Deep* [C], *Lure of the Ring* [C]

• If Gandalf the White is in the battle and using his "White Rider" ability then this card may *not* be played, since it requires Nazgûl Leadership (which is negated by the "White Rider" ability for the whole battle).

• This card can only be played if *Nazgûl* Leadership is present (including the Witch-king). If activated, the *entire* Leader re-roll (*including* Leadership from other sources e.g., Saruman) is augmented.

• Note that this Combat effect is *not* optional, e.g., if played when a Shadow Army only has 1 Leadership total (from a Nazgûl), that 1 Nazgûl Leadership must be forfeited, negating the entire Leadership re-roll.

• "Subtracting" Nazgûl Leadership (as is written on older printings) is synonymous with "forfeiting" Nazgûl Leadership. FAQ

3x "We Come to Kill" (7) *Half-orcs and Goblin-men* [A], *Hill-trolls* [A], *Olog-hai* [A]

• Hits are scored only on 5 or more. Cards which affect the Combat roll (e.g., "Advantageous Position", "Daylight") do *not* affect this attack (or any other pre-/post-combat attacks) in any way.

• Only Elite units that remain *after* resolving all combat damage can be used for this effect and only those Elite units *in* the battle can be used (i.e., Elite units in a rearguard cannot be used).

3x "Words of Power" (1) *The Lidless Eye* [C], *The Ringwraiths Are Abroad* [C], *Worn with Sorrow and Toil* [C]

• If Gandalf the White is in the battle and using his "White Rider" ability then this card effect is still playable as it only requires the *presence* of Nazgûl; all *abilities* of the selected Companion are cancelled. e.g., Gandalf the White's "White Rider" ability *is* cancelled if he is chosen (but only for the current Combat round).

• "Daring Defiance" (initiative 0) usually cancels "Words of Power" (initiative 1). However, if Gandalf the White has forfeited Leadership for "White Rider", then "Daring Defiance" *is* playable but has *no* effect (since all Leadership cannot be forfeited, as part is already allocated to "White Rider") and so "Words of Power" *will* apply (and Companions not affected by "Words of Power" *retain* their Leadership in this case).

• "Sudden Strike" has initiative 2 and so happens *after* "Words of Power" cancels a Companions Leadership and abilities. Note this reduction in Leadership when rolling for "Sudden Strike".

• Free Peoples Cards that require the *presence* of a Companion are not directly cancelled by this card. However, effects that rely upon Companion abilities may be, e.g., "Blade of Westernesse" requires the *presence* of a Hobbit so one hit on the Free Peoples Leader re-roll will still eliminate a Shadow Minion in the battle even if "Words of Power" has cancelled that Hobbit's abilities. "Andúril", on the other hand, specifically requires forfeiting the Leadership of Strider/Aragorn so is negated if "Words of Power" is used against Strider/Aragorn (as his Leadership is cancelled by "Words of Power").

Hundreds of hours of research and documentation of the many complex card interactions have gone into this document over the last five years. This is for everyone who enjoys *War of the Ring*; feel free to click this link if this work has been useful in your games. ☺ https://buymeacoffee.com/roysubs

Buy me a coffee

Appendix: Card-play examples

• **An example on hand limits.** The Free Peoples player has six cards in hand and plays "House of the Stewards" with an Event die. First, he recruits a unit and then draws two cards from the Strategy deck as instructed by the card text for a total of seven cards in hand. He must now *immediately* discard down to six cards. Now, if Gandalf the Grey is the Guide of the Fellowship, he may *optionally* take another card from the Character deck (must be the same card type that was played) for a total of seven cards, so he must *again* discard down to six cards (i.e., you must discard down to the six-card hand limit after drawing all cards for *each step* taken). [web]

• **Playing cards that do nothing.** This is permitted (and there may be reasons to do it) but you can *never* play a card if a play condition is not met. e.g., "Corsairs of Umbar" is playable even if no Shadow Army is in Umbar as no play condition on the card prevents it; this may seem redundant, but the rules permit it. Similarly, "Words of Power" could be played in a battle, even if no Companion is in that battle. Both examples would have no effect but could be done as a bluff, or to get a new card draw with the Witch-king's "Sorcerer" ability.

• **Gandalf the White, "White Rider" ability.** This can only be announced at the very start of a battle and lasts for the entirety of that battle (i.e., it cannot be turned on or off at each new Combat round; it is either on for the whole battle or off for the whole battle). Gandalf already has *forfeited* his Leadership to use this ability which is why "Daring Defiance" is playable (as a least one Companion is in the battle) but has *no effect* since Gandalf *cannot* forfeit his Leadership as is required by "Daring Defiance". The Shadow player *cannot* play any card that requires *Nazgûl* Leadership when this ability is in use (i.e., "Dread and Despair", "Foul Stench", "They are Terrible"), but *may* play cards that require the *presence* of Nazgûl (so "Black Breath" and "Words of Power" are legal to play).

• **Gandalf, The Grey Wanderer, Guide ability** allows drawing the same type of card, only if an *Event* die was used and Gandalf is the Guide at the *end* of the Action. *Example 1.* Gandalf is the Guide. An Event die is used to play "We Prove the Swifter" and Gandalf separates. At the end of the Action, Gandalf is no longer Guide, so his Guide ability is *not* triggered. [web] *Example 2.* Strider is the Guide and Gandalf is also in the Fellowship. An Event die is used to play "We Prove the Swifter" and Strider separates, so Gandalf must become the Guide (as the highest Level Companion) and so this Guide ability *may* be triggered to draw another Event card as the same type played.

• **The Witch-king, The Black Captain, "Sorcerer" ability** allows drawing the same type of Event card, only if a Combat card was used in the first Combat round of a battle in which the Witch-king participated. Note that this card draw only happens after *all* choices have been made on whether the attacker will continue the battle (*including* downgrading an Elite to a Regular if continuing a Stronghold siege battle) and if the defender chooses to retreat. [web] If the Witch-king is in a rearguard or is eliminated *during* the first Combat round, this ability is *not* triggered. [web]

• **"The Palantír of Orthanc" Character Event card** allows drawing from *any* deck, only if an *Event* die was used to play the card. This card draw only happens after the entire Action has completed, i.e., if playing a card that starts a battle, you may only draw an Event card for "The Palantír of Orthanc" once the entire battle and Action completes. The card requires Saruman to be in play so if he is eliminated during this battle, then "The Palantír of Orthanc" is removed from play immediately and this ability is *not* triggered at the end of the Action.

Appendix: Moving and Retreating

• **"Free Regions".** A region is free for a player when it does not contain an enemy Army and/or an enemy-controlled Settlement. A region containing a Stronghold controlled by the enemy is also free for a player when the Stronghold is besieged by an Army of that player. [p10]

• **Moving.** Army units "At War" can move into *any* "free region". Army units *not* "At War" may only move into regions of *no* Nation, or *their* Nation (which includes *enemy-controlled Settlements* of *their* Nation, if empty).

• **Retreating.** Army units (*even* if *not* "At War") can retreat to *any* "free region". *Example 1.* The North is not "At War" and Dale is attacked. If the Battle continues to a second round, the Army may retreat to Erebor even though The North or Dwarven Nation are both not "At War". *Example 2.* A Free Peoples Army in Dimrill Dale may *not* retreat into an empty and *uncaptured* Moria (as it is *controlled* by the Shadow), or into an empty and *captured* Lórien (as it is *controlled* by the Shadow) but *could* retreat into either if they are currently *besieged* by a friendly Army. These examples also apply to the "Scouts" Combat card.

Tolkien Accented Word Lookup Table

Non-accented searches will fail to find a match in the above document. This table shows the correct term to search for.

Simplified Term	Correct Term	Definition
Ainulindale	**Ainulindalë**	"Music of the Ainur", from before the beginning of Time and the creation of Arda.
Anarion	**Anárion**	Brother of Isildur and the youngest son of Elendil, the High King of Gondor and Arnor.
Anduril	**Andúril**	The reforged sword from the shards of Narsil, also called The Flame of the West.
Barad-dur	**Barad-dûr**	Sindarin for "Dark Tower", also Lugbúrz in the Dark Speech. Completed by Sauron in the Second Age, destroyed following the victory of the Last Alliance of Elves and Men at the end of that age and rebuilt in the Third Age, 67 years before the War of the Ring.
Cirdan	**Círdan**	Círdan the Shipwright. A Telerin Elf, great mariner and shipwright, Lord of the Falas and then of the Balar, one of the wisest and perhaps the mightiest of the Moriquendi. He was the bearer of the Great Ring Narya, which he in turn gave to Gandalf.
Curunir	**Curunír**	"Man of Skill", the Sindarin name for the Wizard that Men called Saruman.
Dain	**Dáin**	Dáin II 'Ironfoot' (T.A. 2767-3019, aged 252 years). Lord of the Iron Hills and King under the Mountain. In his life, he fought in the Battle of Azanulbizar, the Battle of Five Armies and the Battle of Dale.
Deagol	**Déagol**	Also Nahald. A Stoor-hobbit of Gladden Fields. Best friend of Sméagol until his discovery of the Ring.
Druadan **Druedain**	**Drúadan** **Drúedain**	(sg. Drúadan) or Drúath (sg. Drû). A race of wild Men, also called Woses or Wild Men of the Woods by the Rohirrim.
Dunadan **Dunedain**	**Dúnadan** **Dúnedain**	(sg. Dúnadan). Men of the West, descendants of Edain and the survivors of Númenor. "Elf-friends" who sided with the Ñoldor. In the beginning of their history, the Dúnedain were blessed with a lifespan thrice the life of lesser men, yet this ever diminished over the course of the Third Age.
Ea	**Eä**	Literally "be" or "exist". Middle-earth was a continent on Arda. Eä refers to all of creation.
Earendil	**Eärendil**	Half-elven mariner who voyaged to Valinor. Father of Elros, the first King of Númenor, and of Elrond.
Eomer	**Éomer**	The son of Théodwyn and Éomund. After their parents' death, Éomer and his sister Éowyn were adopted by their uncle Théoden, King of the Rohirrim. He is the leader of the forces of Rohan who attack and kill the Uruk-hai who had kidnapped the hobbits Merry Brandybuck and Pippin Took.
Eowyn	**Éowyn**	"Horse-joy" or "lover of horses" in Old English (being a combination of her parents' names: Éomund and Théodwyn), the language Tolkien adapted to represent Rohirric. Éo- sounds like "eh-ah" with the "ah" just barely pronounced, while y is the same sound as German ü or French u.
Feanor	**Fëanor**	Ñoldorin elf that departed from Valinor in the land of Aman, where the Ñoldor had lived with the Valar. He was born in Valinor, the only child of Finwë, High King of the Ñoldor, and was a craftsman, gem-smith, and warrior, the maker of the Silmarils and inventor of the Tengwar script.
Grima	**Gríma**	Gríma, called Wormtongue, was the chief counsellor to King Théoden of Rohan. Bought by the corrupted Wizard Saruman, he was his mole in the Edoras court and worked to weaken the Rohirrim. His treachery exposed, Gríma fled to Isengard and was entrapped in Orthanc with Saruman.
Grishnakh	**Grishnákh**	Orc Captain of Mordor. Led Mordor Orcs who joined Uruk-hai taking Merry and Pippin to Isengard.
Khamul	**Khamûl**	A Ringwraith and second to the Witch-king. Held Dol Guldur as Sauron's lieutenant. After the Witch-king was slain, he became the Lord of Nazgûl for a short period.
Khazad-dum	**Khazad-dûm**	In Sindarin "Hadhodrond", which became "Moria" after its fall into darkness.
Lorien	**Lórien**	"Dream Land", home of Galadriel and Celeborn. Also, another name for the Valar Irmo.
Lothlorien	**Lothlórien**	"The Dreamflower", older name for Lórien.
Mumakil	**Mûmakil**	Known in Westron as Oliphaunts. Large creatures resembling elephants; used in battle by Haradrim.
Namarie	**Namárië**	"Farewell", the name of Galadriel's lament in Lórien. "Galadriel's Lament in Lórien", which in Quenya is "Altariello nainië Lóriendessë"
Nazgul	**Nazgûl**	Ringwraiths in Black Speech, Úlairi (Quenya), Black Riders or The Nine. *"Nine he gave to Mortal Men, proud and great, and so ensnared them. Long ago they fell under the dominion of the One, and they became Ringwraiths."*
Numenor	**Númenor**	Island gifted to men by the Valar.
Numenorean	**Númenórean**	The people of Númenor, descendants of the Edain.
Olorin	**Olórin**	Gandalf to the Men of Arnor, also 'the Grey' and later 'the White'. Originally named Olórin (Quenya). An Istar (Wizard), dispatched to Middle-earth in the Third Age to combat the threat of Sauron. Elves named him Mithrandir, known as Incánus in the South, and as Tharkûn to the Dwarves.
Palantir **Palantiri**	**Palantír** **Palantíri**	Also known as the Seven Stones or the Seven Seeing-stones. Stone spheres used for communication and intelligence gathering. Eight were known, with seven in Middle-earth. Plural form is 'Palantíri'.
Rhun	**Rhûn**	North and South Rhûn, land of the Easterlings.
Smeagol	**Sméagol**	Gollum, originally named Sméagol (or Trahald), was at first a Stoor, one of the three early Hobbit-types. He died aged 589 years when he destroyed the One Ring.
Theoden	**Théoden**	Théoden, son of Thengel, seventeenth King of Rohan, last of the Second Line of the House of Eorl.
Tinuviel	**Tinúviel**	"Nightingale", name given to Lúthien of Doriath by Beren when he first saw her dancing in the forest.
Turin	**Túrin**	Túrin Turambar (F.A. 464–499) was a hero of the First Age whose life was dominated by the Curse of the Enemy. His deeds are told in "Narn i Chîn Húrin" ("The Tale of the Children of Húrin").
Udun	**Udûn**	Morgoth's oldest and greatest fortress more commonly called Utumno, and the Balrog's ancient home. *"You cannot pass. The dark fire will not avail you, flame of Udûn. Go back to the Shadow! You cannot pass."*
Ugluk	**Uglúk**	Leader of the Uruk-hai who were sent from Isengard to pursue the Fellowship of the Ring in TA 3019.
Undomiel	**Undómiel**	Arwen the Half-elven, daughter of Elrond and Celebrían. Often called Arwen Undómiel or "Evenstar".
The Valar (the **Aratar**, "Exalted", or "High Ones of Arda", were the eight greatest of the Valar). **Eru Ilúvatar** is the supreme deity of Eä and Arda.		In descending order of power, the Aratar were Manwë, Varda, Ulmo, Yavanna, Aulë, Mandos, Nienna, and Oromë. Melkor (Morgoth, The Enemy) was the most powerful of all but removed from the Valar after his rebellion. Although Tulkas was a Vala who lived in Valinor, he was not of the Aratar.
The Ainur of Arda		**Kings of the Valar:** Manwë (Súlimo), Ulmo (Ulubôz), Aulë (Návatar), Oromë (Aldaron), Námo (Mandos), Irmo (Lórien), Tulkas (Astaldo). **Queens of the Valar:** Varda (Elentári), Yavanna (Kementári), Nienna, Estë (Chief of the Maiar), Vairë, Vána, Nessa.
Maiar (Lesser Ainur) loyal to Manwë		Eönwë (Herald of Manwë), Ilmarë (Handmaiden of Varda), Ossë, Uinen, Salmar, Melian, Arien, Tilion, Curumo (Saruman), Olórin (Gandalf), Aiwendil (Radagast), Alatar (Morinehtar), Pallando (Rómestámo).
Maiar (Lesser Ainur) loyal to Melkor / Úmaiar		Sauron (Mairon), Gothmog (Lord of Balrogs), Durin's Bane (The Balrog of Moria).